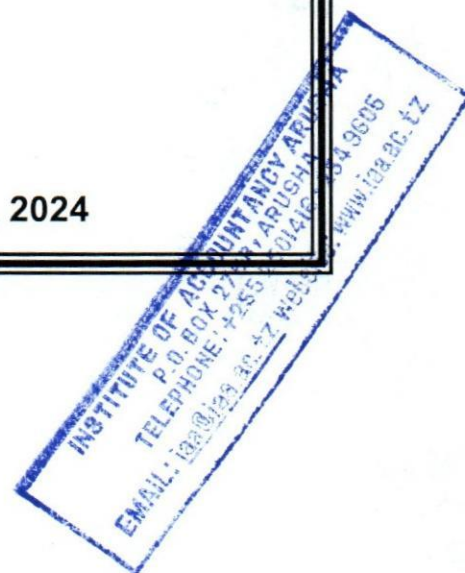




**INSTITUTE OF
ACCOUNTANCY
ARUSHA**

GUIDELINES FOR MASTER DEGREE PROGRAMMES

REVISED VERSION, FEBRUARY, 2024



REVISED REGULATIONS, 2024

The guidelines approved by the Governing Council during its **03/2023-24** meeting held on 28th February 2024.

APPROVED,

.....
Chairperson of the Governing Council

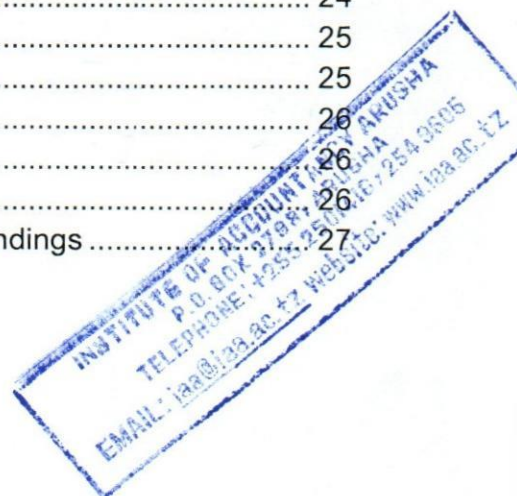
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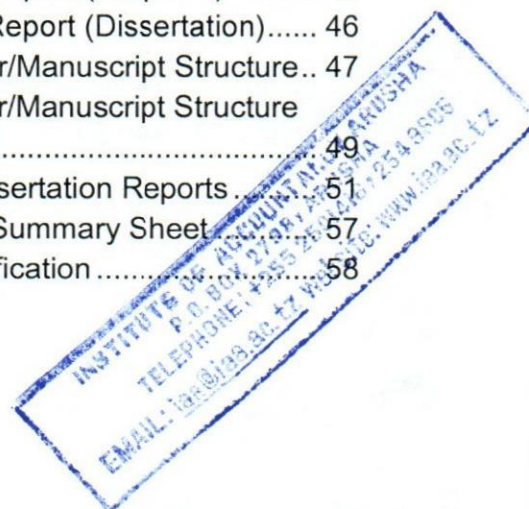
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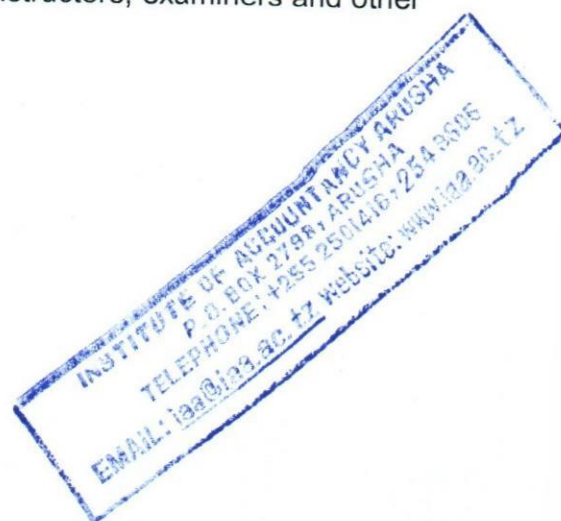


PREFACE

The Institute of Accountancy Arusha (IAA) is a parastatal Educational Institution established by the Institute of Accountancy Arusha Act of 1990. As part of its mission, the IAA aspires to provide high-quality competency-based training and offer research and consultancy services through applied technology. Based on its new strategic plan for 2022/23 to 2025/26, IAA seeks to be an exemplary centre of excellence in modern business management training, research, and consultancy services. Research and innovation are the means by which IAA will reach that desired degree of excellence. In accomplishing the Institute's functions, eight core values are highly considered namely customer-focused, integrity and transparency, excellence and professionalism, creativity and innovation, accessibility, responsibility, teamwork, and diversity and equal opportunity for all.

The Institute finds it essential whenever necessary to undertake a review of its various guidelines for improving efficient and effective administration of different degree programmes. In its history, guidelines for running of master degree programmes came into existence in 2020 when the Institute began to offer master degree programmes independent. Formerly, the postgraduate degree programmes were offered in collaboration with Coventry University (UK) and Golgotias University (India). Besides, on 23rd August 2023, the Governing Council of the Institute approved the implementation of a new organization structure. The management of postgraduate studies was among of organs whose powers, responsibilities, and mandates were greatly impacted by this transformation. The establishment of faculties, where master programs are no longer centrally supervised, was one of the key changes. These all highlight the necessity of revising the guidelines for running master degree programmes. We believe that, the revised guidelines for master degree programmes will be an essential tool for prospective and registered students, supervisors, instructors, examiners and other stakeholders.

Rector



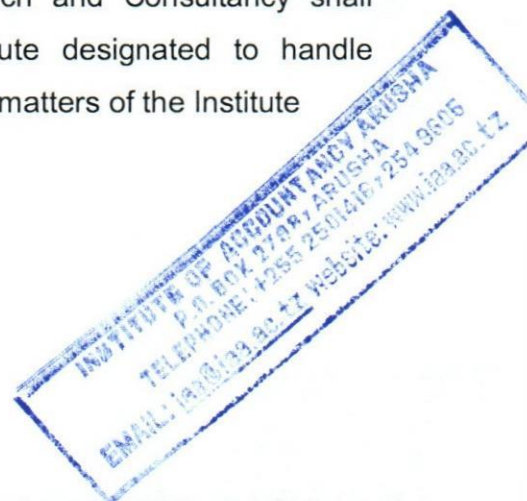
LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

APA	American Psychological Association
DASS	Directorate of Academic Support Services
DR-ARC	Deputy Rector – Academic, Research and Consultancy
GPA	Grade Point Average
IAA	Institute of Accountancy Arusha
HOD	Head of Department
NACTVET	National Council for Technical and Vocational Education and Training
TCU	Tanzania Commission for Universities

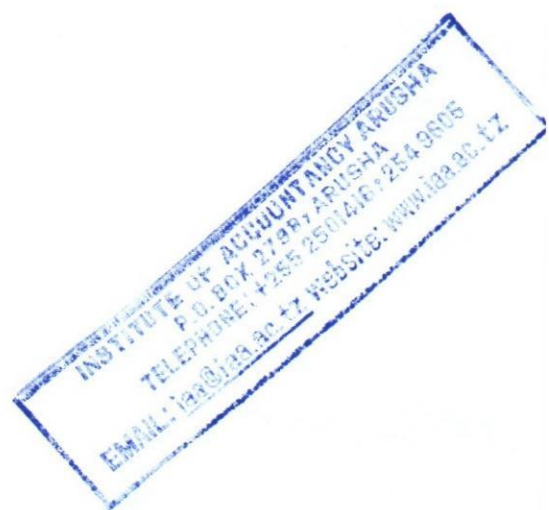


DEFINITION OF KEY TERMS

Academic Board	Academic board shall mean an administrative organ established by Regulation 6 of the Assessment of Student's Performance Regulations" made under section 22 of the IAA Act (Cap. 240 R.E. 2002)
Academic programme	Academic programme shall mean a course of studies arranged to be undertaken within a specified period of time, and in these guidelines, accompanied by a prescribed Master Degree Award after successful completion of all its requirements.
Academic Year	Academic year shall mean such period relating to any academic programme conducted by the Institute, as the Governing Council may determine.
Admission	Admission shall mean an approval to report for registration as a student of the Institute
Block system	Block system shall mean taking only one module for certain duration until the material is covered.
Conditional registration	Conditional registration shall mean partial registration for students who have not been able to meet registration requirements.
Departmental Examiners' Committee	Departmental examiners' committee shall mean a committee established by Regulation 4 of "Assessment of Student's Performance Regulations" made under section 22 of the IAA Act (Cap. 240 R.E. 2002).
Deputy Rector – Academics Research and Consultancy	Deputy Rector – Academics Research and Consultancy shall mean a senior officer of the Institute designated to handle Academic, Research and Consultancy matters of the Institute



Examination	Examination shall mean class test, quiz, assessed assignment, term paper, semester examination, supplementary examination, special examination and dissertation.
Institute	Institute shall mean the Institute of Accountancy Arusha
Module	Module shall mean an independent package of learning related to an academic programme studied by a student for fixed number of hours during a semester that can be credited towards the final award at any given level.
Registration	Registration shall mean a process through which a student agrees to be a student member of the Institute, abide by the Institute's Regulations and Guidelines and become liable for fee payment.
Semester	Semester shall mean an academic period in which one set of course modules in each discipline is offered and assessed.
Student or candidate	Student/candidate shall mean any person admitted to the Institute to pursue any academic programme other than short term programmes
The Governing Council	The Governing Council shall mean the Council of the Institute of Accountancy Arusha



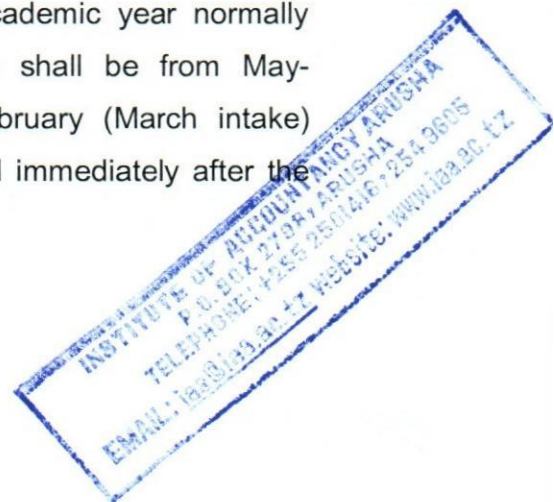
PART I:
APPLICATION, ADMISION AND REGISTRATION

1.0 Mode of Application

1.1 IAA has the following master degree programmes administered in form of conventional/evening classes and blended programmes:

- i. Master of Accountancy (MA)
- ii. Master of Accounting and Finance (MAF)
- iii. Master of Finance and Investment (MFI)
- iv. Master of Science in Finance and Banking (MSc-FB)
- v. Master of Science in Project Planning and Management (MSc-PPM)
- vi. Master of Business Administration in Procurement and Supplies Management (MBA-PSM)
- vii. Master of Business Administration in Corporate Management (MBA-CM)
- viii. Master of Business Administration in Policy Development and Execution (MBA-PDE)
- ix. Master of Education Management (MEM)
- x. Master of Human Resources Management (MHRM)
- xi. Master of Business Administration in Leadership and Governance (MBA-LG)
- xii. Master of Arts in Peace and Security Studies (MA-PSS)
- xiii. Master of Information Security (MIS)
- xiv. Master of Business Administration in Information Technology Management (MBA-ITM)

1.2 There shall be two intakes for master degree programmes and the registration shall be at the beginning of the academic year normally October and March. Invitation for applications shall be from May-September (October intake) and December-February (March intake) every year. Successful applicants will be notified immediately after the selection.



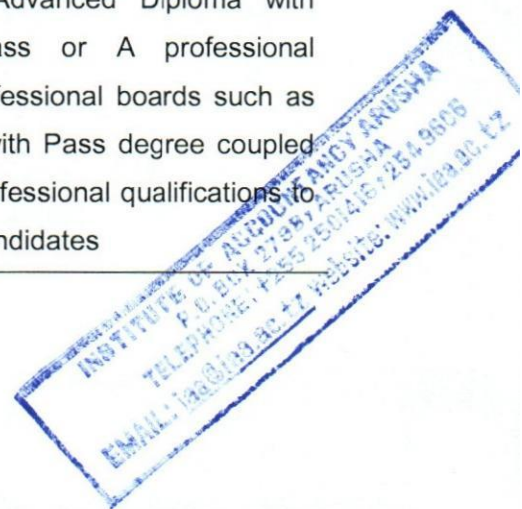
- 1.3 All applications for master degree programmes training at Institute shall be submitted to the DR-ARC through an online application system available at the IAA website www.iaa.ac.tz.
- 1.4 Certificates obtained from foreign higher learning institutions shall be subject to recognition by the Tanzania Commission for Universities (TCU). It is the applicant's responsibility to ensure this is done prior to application.
- 1.5 An applicant will be required to pay a non-refundable application fee. The fee shall be paid when the application forms are submitted in the online system.
- 1.6 The application fee may be revised from time to time by the Institute, as the need arises. Information on the fee applicable for any given year shall be obtained from the Directorate of Academic Support Services, and the Institute Website.

2.0 Admission requirements

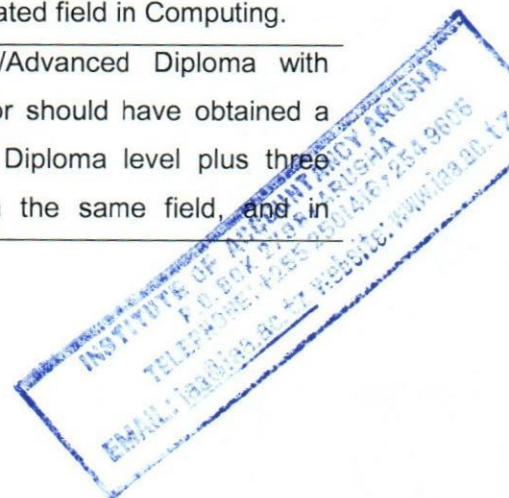
- i. In selecting students, IAA shall consider, among others, the qualifications of the applicants and the admission capacity for the programmes. The applicant shall have the minimum qualifications as indicated in the respective Curriculum information report (CIR) for specific programme requirements to be admitted into IAA master degree programmes:

Table 1: Admission Requirements for master degree Programmes

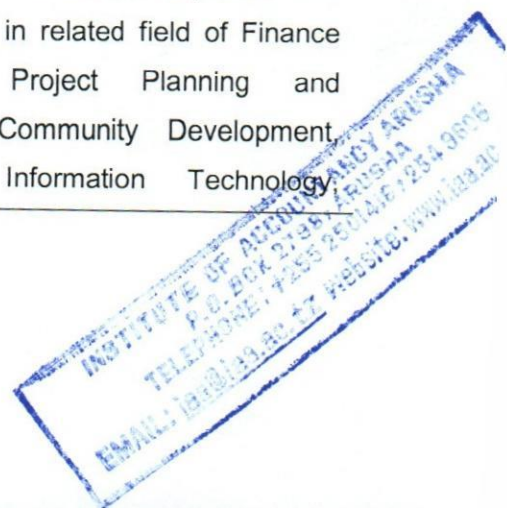
S/No.	Programme	Admission requirements
1	Master Degree in Accounting and Finance	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class or A professional qualification recognized by professional boards such as CSP, CPA-T. or A candidate with Pass degree coupled with Postgraduate Diploma. Professional qualifications to be added advantage to Pass candidates



2	Master Degree in Accountancy	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class or A professional qualification recognized by professional boards such as CSP, CPA-T. or A candidate with Pass degree coupled with Postgraduate Diploma.
3	Masters of Science in Project Planning and Management	Holders of a bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class in related field of Project Planning and Management, Economics, Engineering, Community Development, Health Management, Agro-Business, Accounting, Finance, Banking, Information Technology, Computer Science, Sociology, Planning and Construction Management.
4	Master of Science in Banking and Finance	Holders of Bachelor Degree/Advanced Diploma in Banking and Finance, Banking, Finance, Accountancy, Business Administration with at least Lower Second GPA, or Pass Class with at least three years of working experience in a relevant field of study or a Postgraduate Diploma.
5	Master in Human Resources Management	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class.
6	Master of Information Security	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class in Information Technology, Computer Science, Telecommunication, Computer Engineering, Computer Forensics, Computer Security, Information Systems or any related field in Computing.
7	Master of Business Administration in Information Technology Management	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class in Information Technology, Computer Science, Telecommunication, Computer Engineering, Computer Forensics, Computer Security, Information Systems or any related field in Computing.
8	Master of Business Administration in Corporate Management	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class or should have obtained a PASS at Bachelor/Advanced Diploma level plus three years working experience on the same field, and in



		Business Administration, Business Management, Economics, Public Administration, Marketing, Industrial Management, General Management, Banking, Strategic Studies, International Relations Business Management and any social related programmes.
9	Master of Business Administration in Leadership and Governance	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class in relevant fields.
10	Master of Business Administration in Procurement and Supplies Management	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class in any field of study or have a professional qualification (CPSP or CSP) from recognized professional board (PSPTB).
11	Master of Business Administration in Policy Development and Execution	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class in areas of Business Administration, Economics, Public Administration, Marketing, Industrial Management, General Management, Political Science, Human Resources, Education, Banking, Strategic Studies, International Relations Business Management and any social related programmes.
12	Master of Education and Management	Holders of bachelor degree with minimum GPA of 2nd Class in Education both Arts and Science
13	Master of Arts in Peace and Security Studies	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class in Diplomacy, Political Science, Human Resources, Education, Military Subjects, War Studies, Banking, Economics, Diploma in Security, Strategic Studies, International Relations Business Management and any social related programmes.
14	Master Degree in Finance and Investment	Holders of bachelor degree/Advanced Diploma with minimum GPA of 2nd Class in related field of Finance ,Investment, Accounting, Project Planning and Management, Economics, Community Development Agro-Business, Banking, Information Technology.



Procurement and Logistics Management or A professional qualification recognized by professional boards such as CPSP or CSP,CPA(T) and CPB from recognized professional boards (PSPTB, NBAA and TIOB) or for A candidate with PASS Degree should have Postgraduate Diploma or have at least three years of working experience in a relevant field of study.

15th Any other programme approved by relevant authorities

- ii. It is an offence to submit false information when applying for admission. Applicants who will be discovered to have submitted forged certificates or any other false information will not be considered for registration, and appropriate legal actions will be taken against them.

2.1 Deferment of Admission

Deferment of admission will not be entertained. Under such circumstances, the applicant who has been admitted at the Institute but unable to register in the respective academic year and intake shall be required to apply afresh.

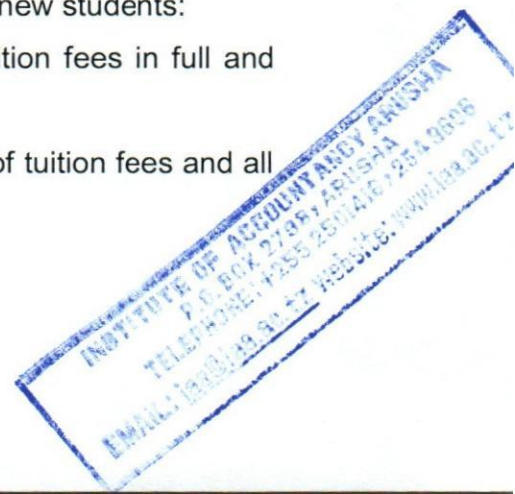
2.2 Conditions for Re-Admission

A student who has been discontinued from a programme of study may be re-admitted to any programme in accordance with "Assessment of Student's Performance Regulations" made under section 22 of the IAA Act (Cap. 240 R.E. 2002).

3.0 Registration

3.1 General Registration procedures

- i. Registration shall be done in the first three weeks of the respective intake and academic year.
- ii. There shall be three categories of registration for new students:
 - a) Full year registration: shall mean paying tuition fees in full and other costs payable to the Institute.
 - b) Partial registration: shall mean paying 40% of tuition fees and all prescribed costs payable to the Institute.

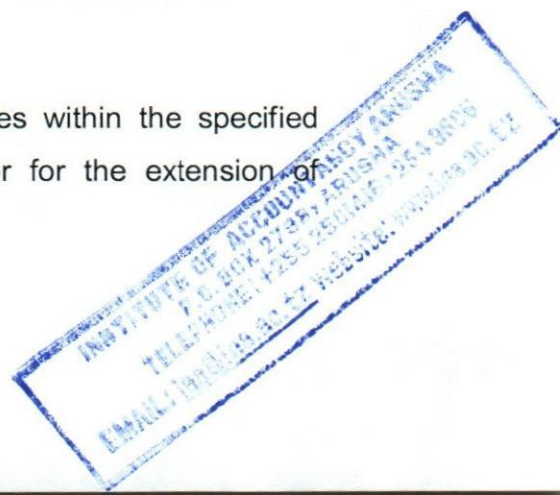


- c) Conditional registration: shall mean paying tuition fees and prescribed costs payable to the Institute after registration. This category is granted subject to approval of the Rector and filling appropriate agreement form.
- iii. The costs payable to the Institute (registration fee, examination fee, wear and tear, student organization, identity card, and NTA exams fees-NACTVET) shall be paid once in full at the beginning of an academic year.
- iv. Notwithstanding of Section 3.1 (ii), all students shall be registered for studies at IAA upon submission of the following:
 - a) Admission letter
 - b) Duly filled registration form.
 - c) Originals and copies of transcripts and certificates (the originals will be returned to the candidate after verification).
 - d) Two colored passport-size photographs.
 - e) Evidence of payment of fees payable to the Institute.
 - f) Birth certificate
 - g) Sponsor's commitment letter (if applicable)
- v. A candidate shall be registered using names as they appear in his/her Form 4 academic certificates. No change of names by students shall be entertained during the course of study at the Institute.
- vi. The deadline for students' registration shall be three (3) weeks after commencement of the semester/block/academic year.
- vii. All admitted students at IAA shall be required to register for studies into the Institute e-learning/Moodle and Students Management System within two (2) weeks after commencement of semester/block/academic year.

- viii. The Institute shall issue Identity Cards (IDs) to registered candidates who have paid required prescribed tuition fees and costs payable to the Institute.
- ix. Unless it happens under compelling/unavoidable circumstances, no student will be allowed to postpone studies after effective commencement of an academic year. In such circumstances, still, the candidate shall have to produce evidence of the reason for postponement. For the purpose of this section, unavoidable/compelling circumstances shall include:
 - a) Sickness,
 - b) Serious social problems [each case shall be well thought-out based on its own worthiness],
 - c) Sponsorship problem, and
 - d) Any other circumstance prescribed by the Academic Board;
- x. Students who fail to pay the prescribed fee shall be expelled from the Institute.

3.2 Duration of Registration Periods

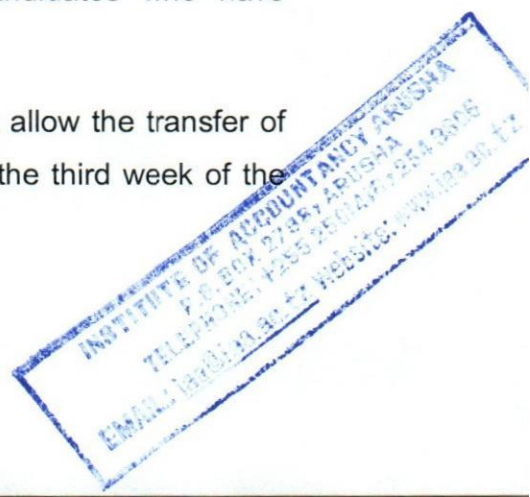
- i. The duration for master degree programmes is twelve (12) months and registration period is thirty-six (36) months.
- ii. The duration shall be divided into three (3) consecutive semesters with the whole of the first semester dedicated to coursework, second semester for coursework and proposal development, and the third semester for dissertation (data collection & report writing).
- iii. No candidate shall be permitted to complete his/her studies in less than the specified duration for registration.
- iv. Candidates who fail to complete their studies within the specified registration period shall apply to the Rector for the extension of registration period.



- v. The maximum duration of extended registration shall not exceed twenty-four (24) months from the specified programme duration stated in section 3.2(i) above.
- vi. All subsequent extensions after the expiration of the study duration shall be charged extension fees of TZS 100,000.00 per month.
- vii. The extension fee may be reviewed by the Institute from time to time.
- viii. Failure of a candidate to complete studies within the maximum allowable time shall mean discontinuation from studies unless applications for further extensions have been approved the Rector based on the justification.
- ix. A candidate who is discontinued from studies for a reason of expiration of maximum registration period shall be informed in writing about such discontinuation. However, failure to access the letter of discontinuation shall not be accepted as a ground for appeal against the discontinuation decision.

3.3 Transfer of Registration

- i. Transfer from one academic programme to another will be allowed only if the candidate possesses the required admission criteria for the programme for which transfer is being sought and a vacancy exists in that programme.
- ii. A candidate who wishes to transfer registration from one programme to another shall write a letter to DR-ARC through HOD and Campus Manager.
- iii. Transfer of registration shall be only for candidates who have completed the registration process.
- iv. Under no circumstances, the DR-ARC shall not allow the transfer of students from one programme to another after the third week of the first semester of an academic year.



3.4 Postponement of Studies

- i. Postponement of studies shall mean stopping studies for a semester or a full academic year where the period will count into the student registration period.
- ii. Except under special circumstances such as sickness, serious problems (each case to be considered on its own merit) or severe sponsorship problem and upon producing satisfactory evidence of the reason for the postponement, no student shall be allowed to postpone studies after effective commencement of an academic year. Request for postponement of studies shall be submitted to the Chairperson of the Academic Board.
- iii. The maximum duration for postponement shall be only one year within maximum registration duration.
- iv. All postponement of studies shall be approved by the Academic Board and shall only be allowed within the maximum duration of the studentship.
- v. Failure to comply with terms of postponement shall result in discontinuation from studies and any monies paid to the Institute by the time of postponement shall not be refunded.
- vi. Permission to resume studies must be sought from the Chairperson of the Academic Board through HOD and Campus Manager.

3.5 De-registration

- i. De-registration refers to withdrawal of the registration. For any reason and at any phase of the studies, a candidate may wish to withdraw his/her registration at the Institute.
- ii. Permission for de-registration from studies shall be granted by the Academic Board.



- iii. The Institute shall de-register a student under the following conditions:
 - a) If a student has been registered on the basis of incorrect information/details.
 - b) If a student does not adhere to the deadline for extending registration without important reasons.
 - c) If a student has already obtained his/her degree or can no longer attain it, apart from in cases that have been explained above.
 - d) If a student has been expelled from the study programme on disciplinary reasons.
 - e) Successfully graduated from studies.
 - f) Deceased students.
- iv. All fees paid to the Institute by the de-registered candidate shall not be reimbursed.
- v. De-registered candidate may apply for re-admission to the same study programme in the following year after. This applies even to a candidate who has been discontinued from studies.



PART II:
MODE OF ASSESSMENT OF STUDENT'S PERFORMANCE

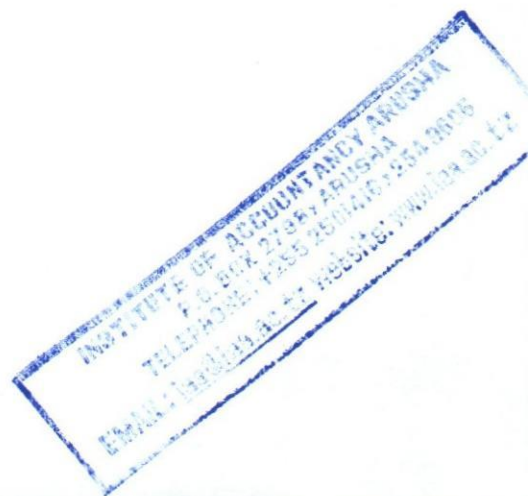
4.0 Mode of Assessment

The following assessment matters have been detailed in "Assessment of Student's Performance Regulations" made under section 22 of the IAA Act (Cap. 240 R.E. 2002):

- a) Eligibility for examinations
- b) Absence from examinations
- c) Assessment schemes, moderation, passing and failing examinations
- d) Conditions for passing a module and progressing from one semester to the next
- e) Conditions for supplementary and special examinations
- f) Conditions for discontinuation
- g) Examination irregularities and disciplinary actions
- h) Publication, nullification and review of examination results
- i) Appeals and decisions of the academic appeals committee

4.1 For that reason, "the Assessment of Student's Performance Regulations" current in use, shall be used to guide the master degree students in the matters above.

4.2 The eligibility of teaching the master degree programmes shall be guided by Academic Quality Standards and other guidelines issued by NACTVET from time to time.



PART III:

ACADEMIC DISHONESTY

5.0 Meaning of Academic Dishonesty

In these guidelines, academic dishonesty means Plagiarism & Academic Cheating in any form of testing or assessing the student's progress and performance.

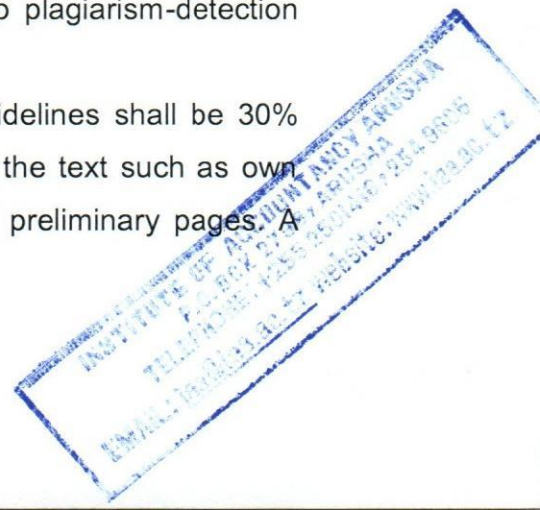
5.1 Instances of plagiarism

If the material or ideas given by the candidate are somebody's and the same candidate does not acknowledge, then, the student will be considered to have committed an act of plagiarism. Instances of plagiarism in examinations or assessments shall generally include:

- a) Handing in someone else's work without his or her permission.
- b) Copying sentences word-by-word from someone else's work including follow student's work without permission.
- c) Repetition with some alterations of selected words, phrases, sentences, or paragraphs from someone else work without his or her permission.
- d) Presentation of data developed or collected by someone without acknowledging the original researcher or source of the information.
- e) Repeating ideas from someone else's work in one's own words without acknowledging the original source.
- f) Incomplete and inconsistent references to the source.
- g) Omitting the acknowledgement of sources in some parts.

5.2 Detection of plagiarism

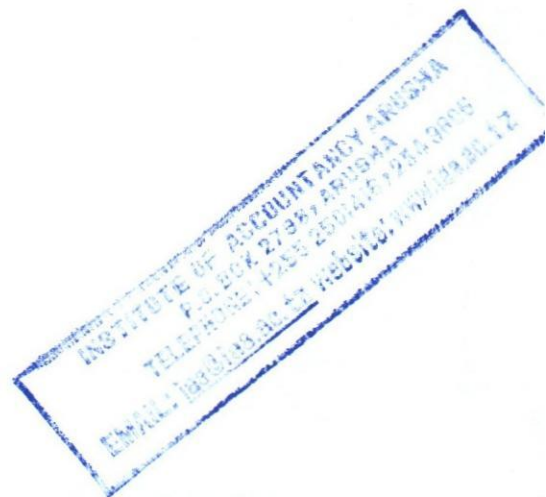
- i. The Supervisor shall verify the student's work to find out whether it is original or not by subjecting the same work to plagiarism-detection software approved by the Institute.
- ii. The cut-off point for the purpose of these Guidelines shall be 30% with exclusion of genuine cases referred to in the text such as own publications, references, bibliography, and the preliminary pages. A



dissertation which has more than 30% similarity shall signify that plagiarism has taken place.

5.3 Disciplinary Measures

Where a student submits a dissertation for examination and is found plagiarized, his or her case shall be dealt as per the "Assessment of Student's Performance Regulations" made under section 22 of the IAA Act (Cap. 240 R.E. 2002).



PART IV:
PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION OF RESEARCH PROPOSAL AND
DISSERTATION

6.0 Formatting and Style Requirements

6.1 A dissertation represents the conclusion of a major research project that should make contribution to knowledge in a given field. Generally, a dissertation reflects a learning experience for a student. To maintain a high standard of a student's work that is acceptable for a graduate degree, the Institute has developed a standard structure to assist students in preparing their dissertations. For matters not covered by these guidelines, each student should consult other sources for additional clarifications. Where these other sources differ or conflict with these guidelines, this guideline shall prevail. The dissertation intends to provide an opportunity for the student to integrate classroom knowledge and practice and enable graduate students to independent studies.

6.2 Candidates must follow the specifications laid out in these guidelines when preparing their research project proposal for Dissertation. A candidate who will NOT follow these specifications, his/her dissertation WILL NOT be accepted. Any questions or clarification on any aspect of these arrangements and requirements shall be directed to the Head of Department.

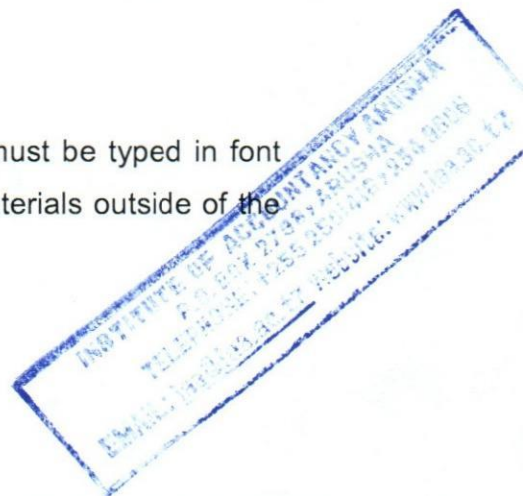
6.3 The recommended style and format for research proposal and dissertation include the following:

i. Language:

The dissertation report shall be written in English Language and shall use British English.

ii. Font:

All texts must be written in Times New Roman, must be typed in font size of 12 except for tables, footnotes or other materials outside of the main text whose font size should be 10.



iii. Margins:

- a) The left-hand margin must be 4.0 cm from the left edge of the paper.
- b) The right-hand margin must be 2.5 cm from the right edge
- c) The top margin must be 4.0 cm from the top of the page.
- d) The bottom margin must be 2.5 cm from the bottom edge of the paper.

iv. Typing and Spacing:

- a) The dissertation report must be printed on good quality A4 (210 x 297 mm), acid free white quality paper.
- b) Except for tables whose texts should be single spaced, spacing for all other texts should be 1.5; and on one side of the paper only.
- c) Except for texts in the tables, all other texts must always be justified.

v. Paragraphs:

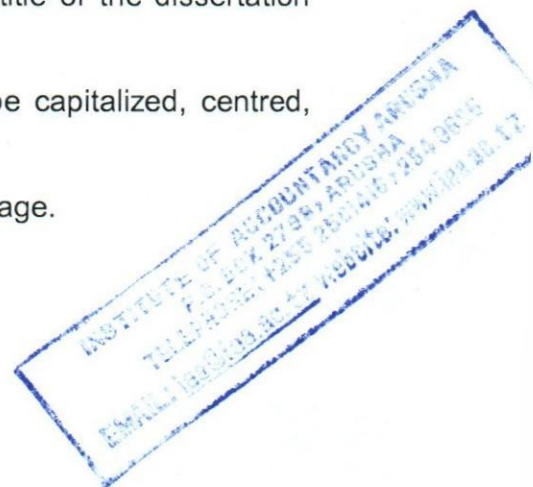
Begin each paragraph and each sub-heading by hitting the enter key once (i.e. there should be one line between the paragraphs to separate them). The paragraphs should not be indented.

vi. Capitalization and Bolding of Words:

Students should as much as possible avoid unnecessary bolding and capitalization of words or sentences. But once they feel there is need to do that, the bolding and capitalization must be used consistently.

vii. Proposals/Dissertation Title and its Chapters:

- a) Write the main title of the dissertation report in capitals of bolded 14 font size. All other texts after the title, such as the author's name, should be in capitals and small letters, and should be in font size of 12, bolded and centred. The title of the dissertation report must not exceed 20 words.
- b) Chapters in the dissertation report must be capitalized, centred, and bolded using font size 12.
- c) Each new chapter should begin on a new page.



viii. Treatment of Abbreviations:

Any subject should be stated in full, followed by an abbreviation or acronyms placed in brackets the first time it appears. For Example: When the name "Institute of Accountancy Arusha" appears for the first time in the texts, it will be written as: Institute of Accountancy Arusha (IAA), and in the subsequent citations only the abbreviation IAA should be used. A list of abbreviations and acronyms used in the dissertation report should be included in the preliminary pages of the document.

ix. Quotations:

Quotations of fewer than four lines can be incorporated into the texts and quotation marks should be used. Quotations of more than four lines are indented and aligned four spaces from the left margin. No quotation marks are required. The quotations should be single spaced, and should be in italics. If you want to omit some words in the middle of a sentence being quoted, it should be indicated by three dots. Also, an omission in a quotation following a complete sentence is shown by three dots.

x. Tables and their Numbering:

- a) Tabular material of five or more horizontal lines is usually presented in the dissertation report as a table. The texts in these tables should be single-spaced.
- b) Students may put more than one table on the same page provided they are separated by four lines.
- c) A table cannot be continued (broken) to the next page unless the titles re-appear in each table. The heading and the table itself are inseparable.
- d) Tables should be referred to by their numbers and NOT by a phrase such as "the previous table" or "the next/following table".
- e) Long tables should be placed in the appendix section.
- f) Table numbering must be consecutive within chapters. For Example, the first table appearing under Chapter One could be numbered as Table 1.1 and the second and the third ones as

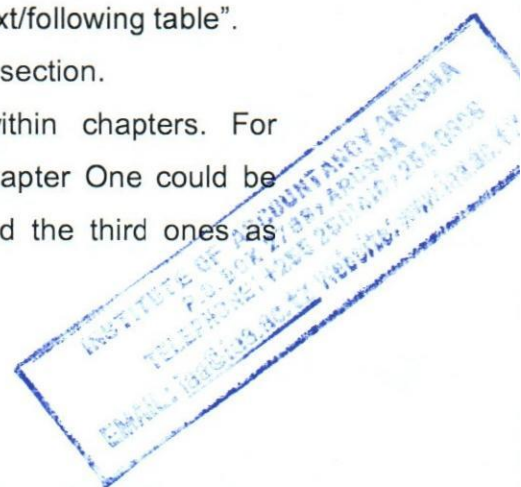
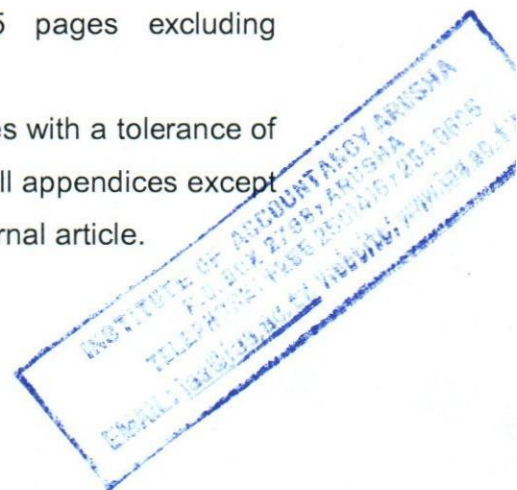


Table 1.2 and Table 1.3 respectively.

- g) The number and the title of the table must appear on top of each table while the source of the material in that table, should appear at the bottom of the table.
 - h) Capitalize only the first letter of the first word of the table-heading, except for proper names of things or abbreviations/acronyms in that table.
- xi. Figures, Diagrams, Graphs, Charts, Illustrations and Photographs
- a) Any diagram, graph, or chart (including a photograph) is usually presented as a figure.
 - b) All figures should be written in full to describe what they are saying. For consistency purposes, they should be numbered and labelled in the same way as tables, with their sources and all other elaborations placed at the bottom of the figures. Unless the figures are big enough to deserve separate pages by themselves, they must be included in the texts.
- xii. Pagination
- a) Paginate all preliminary pages in lower case Roman numerals, i.e. "i", "ii", "iii", etc., beginning with the title page, but not numbering the cover page.
 - b) Number the pages of the body of the dissertation/project report in Arabic numerals, i.e. "1", "2", "3", etc., consecutively, and consistently throughout.
 - c) The page numbers should appear centred at the bottom of each page.
- xiii. Length of the Proposal and Dissertation
- a) The length of proposal shall be 20-25 pages excluding preliminaries and appendices.
 - b) The length of dissertation shall be 70-80 pages with a tolerance of 10% above this limit including footnotes and all appendices except a conference paper/manuscript/published Journal article.



xiv. Referencing Style

All citations should follow the APA Referencing Style using the most recent version.

7.0 Components and layout of Research Proposal

7.1 Title

The title should accurately reflect the scope and content of the study. In addition, it should be concise, simple and catchy in not more than 20 words for research project, dissertation. The title should be informative / descriptive yet discrete and contains the key words of the proposal. Do not use terms like "Research into...", "A Study of..." etc.

7.2 Preliminaries

Research proposal material shall be arranged in the following sequence:

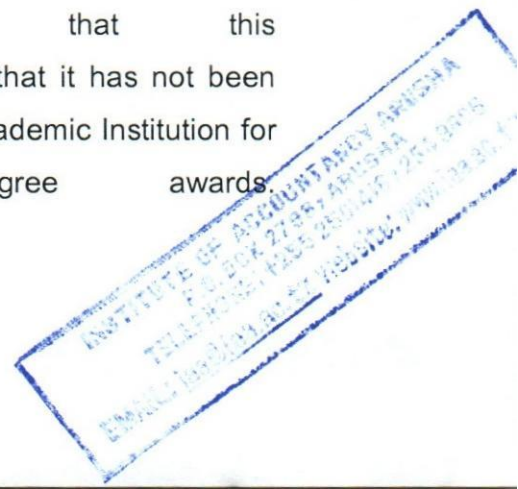
i. Cover page

This bears a centered title of the project in capitals of 14 font size. For example: title of dissertation, author's name, month, Year and caption.

ii. Title Page

- a) Research Title - it should be: concise, simple, catchy (not more than 20 words).
- b) Sub title (if any).
- c) Author/ Student - name of the researcher (students: includes registration number).
- d)Caption - degree requirements (For example: A proposal submitted in Partial fulfillment of the requirements for the Degree of Masters of Business Administration in Corporate Management of the Institute of Accountancy Arusha).
- e) Date of submission - month and year of study. For example June, 2024

- iii. Author's Declaration: For example: I, declare that this proposal/dissertation is my own original work and that it has not been presented and will not be presented to any other academic Institution for similar or any other degree awards.



Signature..... Date.....

- iv. Certification by Supervisor: For example: I, the undersigned certify that I have read and hereby recommend for acceptance by Institute of Accountancy the proposal/dissertation entitled.....in fulfillment of the requirement for the degree of Masters of Business Administration in Corporate Management offered by the Institute of Accountancy Arusha.

Signature Date

Name.....

- v. Copyright: For example: This proposal/dissertation should not be reproduced by any means, in full or in part, except for short extract in a fair dealing, for research or private study, critical scholarly review or discourse with an acknowledgement. No part of this proposal may be reproduced, stored in any retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission of the author or The Institute of Accountancy Arusha.
- vi. Table of contents: Chapters, Sections and corresponding pages.
- vii. List of tables: include titles of tables and their respective page numbers
- viii. List of figures: Any diagram, graph or chart (including a photograph) is usually presented as a figure.
- ix. List of abbreviations /acronyms/symbols used in the research proposal.

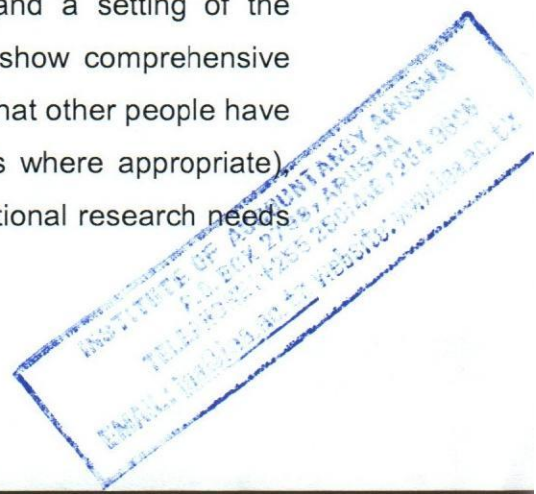
7.3 Chapter One: Introduction

- i. Chapter overview

This is a beginning section. It describes the scope of the chapter. The readers can have an idea about the contents of the chapter before they actually start reading it.

- ii. Background to the Problem

This section provides background information and a setting of the intended research problem. The section should show comprehensive literature review related to the problem: to show what other people have published on the problem (citing specific authors where appropriate) what gaps of knowledge still exist, and what additional research needs.



to be done. It requires evidence and conditions of the existing situations highlighting the gap(s) to make the reader feel the urgency of the problem as well as the need to study it in order to solve the problem or contribute to its solution.

iii. Statement of the Problem

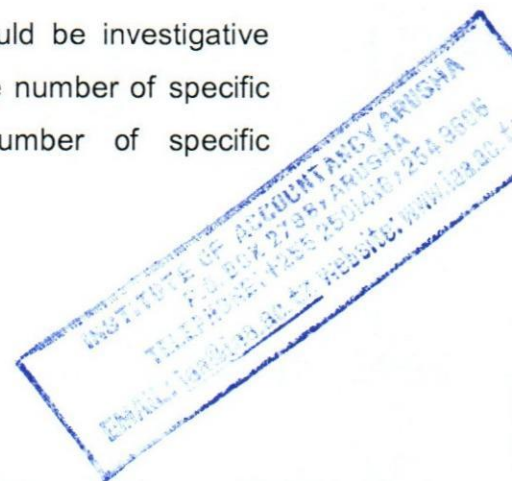
- a) Should clearly state the nature of the problem and its known or estimated magnitude I extent.
- b) Should include "knowledge gap" in its description.
- c) Link the problem to the national development priorities (e.g. Five-Year Development Plan), the regional (e.g. Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan) and the Global Development Agenda (e.g. Sustainable Development Goals)
- d) Presents the reason behind the proposal i.e. what will change when this research is done, or what would happen if the research is not done.
- e) Refers to what has been detected and needs a solution in the practical or theoretical world.
- f) Should be concise and brief (not more than one page)

iv. Research objectives

- a) General Objective: It refers to the general intention of the research, and should spell out what the research is supposed to accomplish in relation to the title.
- b) Specific Objectives: These are specific aims arising directly from the general objective of the study. For each specific objective there must be a method(s) to achieve it. The number of specific objectives should be three but not exceed four.

v. Research Questions

In case research questions are used, they should be investigative questions addressing the specific objectives. The number of specific research questions corresponds with the number of specific objectives.



vi. Hypotheses

Hypotheses are investigative assumptions which guide the study, and they should be testable. Usually are stated as null or alternative hypothesis and is applicable to the quantitative or mixed study.

vii. Scope of the study

The scope provides for the boundary of the research in terms of depth of investigation, content, geographical coverage, time frame, and theoretical coverage.

viii. Significance of the Study

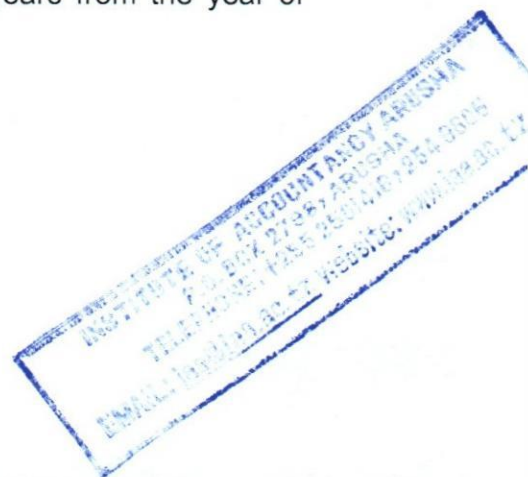
This refers to the relevance of study in terms of academic contributions and practical use that might be made from the findings. It should reflect on the importance of the study and advantages to be derived based on the knowledge creation, technological or socio-economic value to the community.

ix. Organization of the Research Proposal/dissertation

Explain briefly the contents of the research proposal or dissertation. This should appear in chapter one.

7.4 Chapter two: Literature Review

This section deals with the analysis of existing literature on the subject with the objective of revealing contributions, weaknesses and gaps. The Literature Review should be according to the themes of the study and should reflect the objectives, hypotheses, methods and research questions based on empirical and theoretical literature review. Citation should be in accordance with the APA Referencing Style (using the most recent version). Preferably, fifty (50) percent of all citations should not be older than ten years from the year of publication.



i Chapter overview

This is a beginning section. It describes the scope of the chapter. The readers can have an idea about the contents of the chapter before they actually start reading it.

ii Conceptual definitions

Define the key terms of the study. Ideally, the terms are found in the titles, objectives to mention a few.

iii Theoretical Literature Review

The section examines the body of theory (or model) that has accumulated regarding an issue, concept, theory, and phenomenon. The theoretical literature review help establish what theories already exist, the relationships between them, to what degree the existing theories have been investigated, and to develop new hypotheses to be tested.

iv Empirical Literature Review

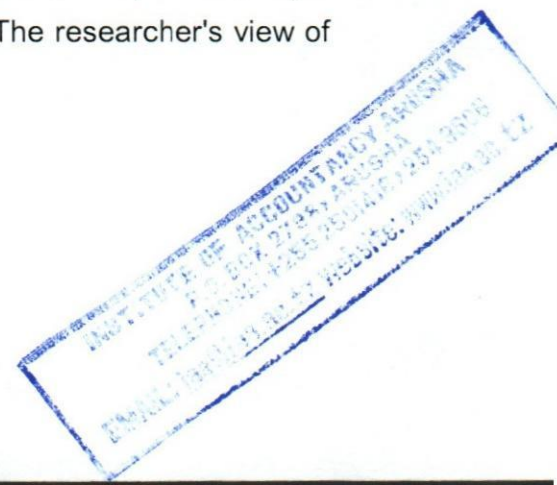
This is a focused discussion of literary materials like previous research, facts, figures, etc. Look at what previous researchers present and discussion. The candidate may use either chronological literature review or thematic literature review.

v Knowledge Gap

The candidate is required to identify something that remains to be done or learned in an area of research.

vi Conceptual framework:

In case a conceptual framework is used, a researcher will demonstrate a scheme of concepts (variables) which will be operationalized in the study so as to achieve the stated objectives. Frameworks are normally presented diagrammatically, and should be well explained. It is a description of major concepts of the study and relationship among them. The researcher's view of how the concepts/variables interact.



7.5 Research Methodology

This is a detailed description of selected methods and should be presented in unambiguous terms. This section comprises of the following concepts:

- i. Chapter overview

This is a beginning section. It describes the scope of the chapter. The readers can have an idea about the contents of the chapter before they actually start reading it.

ii. Research philosophy

The researcher shall indicate and justify the philosophical position of the study.

iii. Research Approach

The researcher shall indicate and justify the appropriate research approach namely qualitative, quantitative or mixed methods.

iv. Research Design

This section describes the nature and pattern the research intends to follow e.g. whether it is historical, descriptive survey, experimental or quasi experimental or cross sectional, etc.

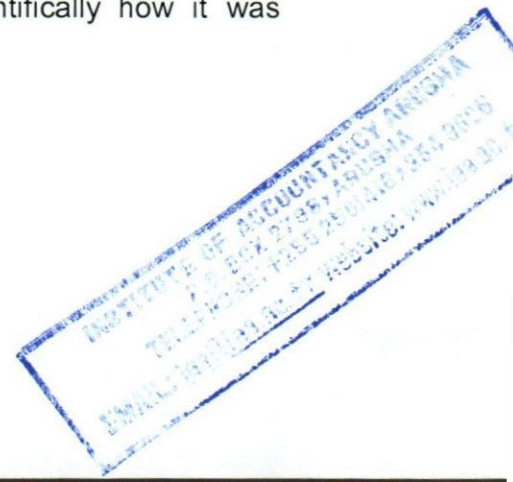
v. Study Area

Description and justification of the geographical area or the location(s) where the proposed research will be carried out should also be given in this section.

vi. Population and sample size

A researcher should describe the population from which samples will be selected.

- a) Population: The researcher shall indicate and justify the target population/sampling frame
- b) Sample size: A researcher shall state the sample size of the representative elements/subject by justifying scientifically how it was derived.



vii. **Sampling Strategies**

A researcher shall explain procedures for selecting representative elements/ subjects from the population if data are to be collected through sampling. It should careful be presented among random sampling and non-random sampling strategies.

viii. **Data collection methods and instruments**

A researcher will explain instruments and procedures to obtain data.

ix. **Data Analysis**

This section explains methods for analyzing data.

x. **Validity and Reliability**

Trustworthiness and diagnostic checking

xi. **Ethical Consideration:**

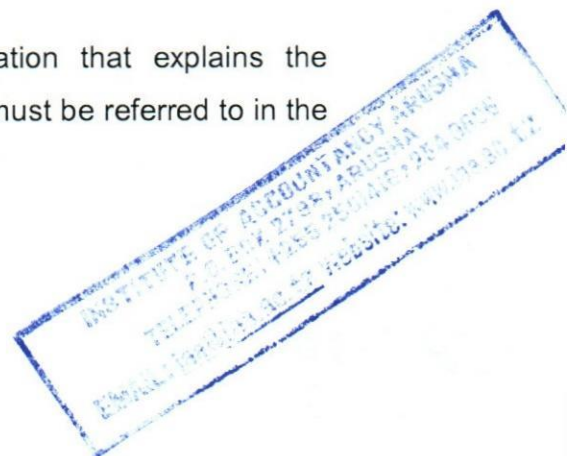
Ethics of the research here refers to the morals of the investigation or Intervention as regards the minimal abuse, disregard, and safety, social and psychological well-being of the person, community and or animals i.e. how the principles of consent, beneficence and justice are handled in the study. Include a statement of where ethical clearance has been or will be obtained.

7.6 References

This is a list of all works cited in the proposal and should be written according to the approved format. The approved format at IAA is IAA: American Psychological Association (APA) Referencing Style (using the most recent version). All sources cited in the text shall be included in the list of references. References shall be arranged in alphabetical order at the end of the proposal/dissertation.

7.7 Appendices

Appendices shall contain detailed data or information that explains the summaries provided in the main text. All appendices must be referred to in the text.

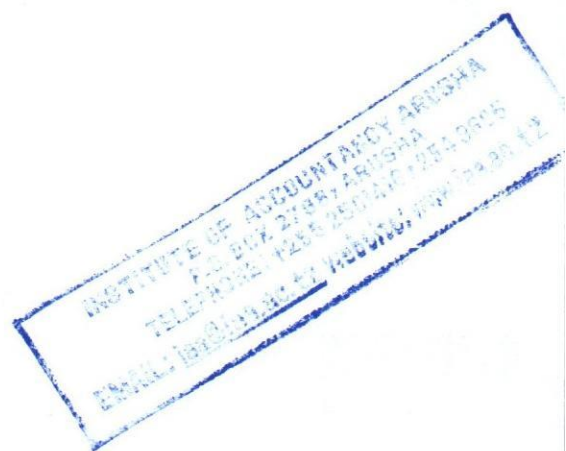


- a) **Field Work Timetable (Work Plan):** Timetable of Activities: This is the schedule / time-table of activities covering the period over which the research is to be implemented Guidelines for Preparation and submission of Research proposal/Dissertation. It could be presented in tabular form or in a Gantt chart. It is a valuable guide for evaluation of a research progress (work plan is applicable in the research proposal).
- b) **Research Budget:** This is the financial plan for implementation of the research. It should be clear, realistic and reasonable (affordable). It should be itemized according to the following: Equipment; Stationery; Materials e.g. nails, wood, chemicals etc.; Travel; Subsistence; Research Assistance; Services (Secretarial, Photocopying, Printing, Binding); Dissemination (Publishing, Conferences etc.); Others (Specify), (research budget is applicable in the research proposal).
- c) **Research Instruments** (Interview Guide, Observation Checklist, Questionnaires guide...) A researcher presents copies of the instruments and procedures used to obtain data. For example: Interview Guide, Questionnaires, Focus Group Discussion, Documentary Review.
- d) **Introduction Letter:** A letter from IAA confirming that the researcher is a student doing research.
- e) **Clearance letter from organization/firm/company:** The students who's their study area is entity/organization/firm/company shall attach a permit from the entity confirming that they were permitted to collect data.

8.0 COMPONENTS AND LAYOUT OF DISSERTATION

8.1 Preliminaries

- i. Cover page
- ii. Title page
- iii. Author's Declaration
- iv. Certification by Supervisor(s)
- v. Copyright
- vi. Dedication, if any



- vii. Acknowledgements
- viii. Abstract
- ix. Table of contents
- x. List of tables
- xi. List of figures
- xii. List of abbreviations/acronyms/symbols used
- xiii. List of conference manuscript(s)/Journal article(s)

8.2 Chapter One: Introduction

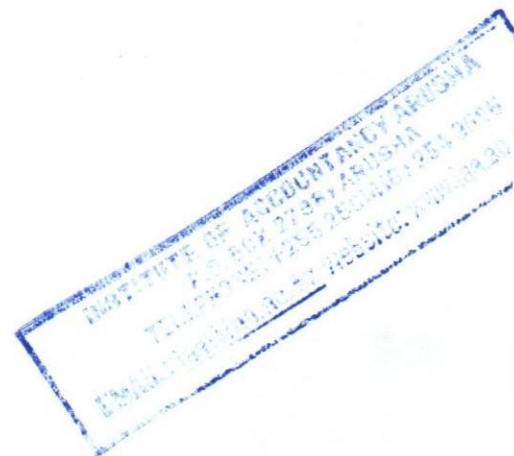
- i. Chapter overview
- ii. Background to the Problem
- iii. Statement of the Problem
- iv. Research objectives (General Objective and Specific Objectives)
- v. Research Questions/ Hypotheses or both (mixed methods studies)
- vi. Scope and Limitations of the Study
- vii. Significance of the Study
- viii. Organization of the Dissertation

8.3 Chapter Two: Literature Review

- i Chapter overview
- ii Conceptual definitions
- iii Theoretical literature review
- iv Empirical literature review
- v Knowledge gap
- vi Conceptual framework (where applicable)

8.4 Chapter Three: Research Methodology

- i Chapter overview
- ii Research approach
- iii Research philosophy
- iv Research design
- v Study area
- vi Population and sampling size
- vii Sampling strategies



- viii Data collection methods
- ix Operationalization of variables (where applicable)
- x Data analysis
- xi Validity and reliability
- xii Ethical consideration

Note: detailed explanations of outline for chapters 1 to 3 is found in section 7 (research proposal).

8.5 Chapter Four: Presentation and Discussion of Findings

Presentation of the findings as captured during the study work and a deeper discussion of the research study findings in relation to the study objectives and research questions should be provided. Justification and critical analysis of the findings are expected. Besides, a researcher should make sure that: data analysis methods are applied correctly, results are well presented, and results of the analysis are clearly linked to the objectives, that is, results should lead to fulfillment of Research Questions or Research Objectives.

i Chapter overview

This is a beginning section. It describes the scope of the chapter. The readers can have an idea about the contents of the chapter before they actually start reading it.

ii Demographics of the respondents

iii Descriptive analysis/aspects (where applicable)

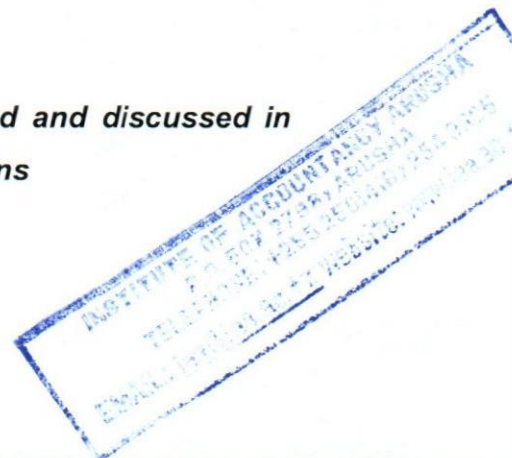
iv Presentation of findings

- a) Specific objective 1
- b) Specific objective 2
- c) Specific objective 3 etc.

v Discussion of findings

- a) Specific objective 1
- b) Specific objective 2
- c) Specific objective 3 etc.

Note: The findings and results should be presented and discussed in relation to Research Objectives or Research Questions



8.6 Chapter Five: Conclusions and Recommendations

This covers a brief summary of the findings from the study and the conclusion thereof. It also includes limitations of the study and areas for further research. This chapter should also have a sub-section which should be titled Critical Evaluation of the Study; this section gives an in-depth and critical analysis on what happened when doing the dissertation. What went well, what went wrong, project management techniques used and what will the researcher do if he/she were to repeat the same project again.

i. Chapter overview

This is a beginning section. It describes the scope of the chapter. The readers can have an idea about the contents of the chapter before they actually start reading it.

ii. Conclusions

The conclusion should be presented in relation to research objectives or research questions. It should also include the contribution to knowledge (knowledge extension).

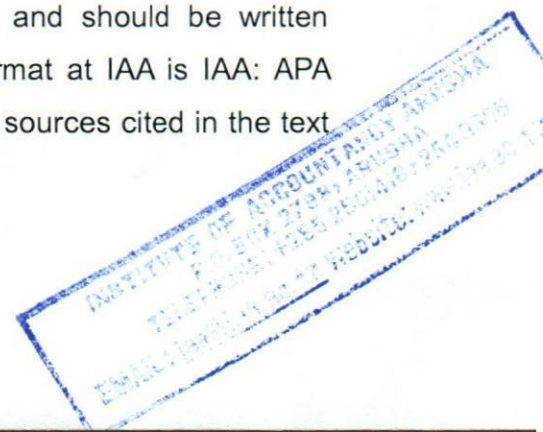
iii. Recommendations

Should be clearly stated, be derived from the conclusions, and mainly be directed to:

- a) Knowledge implication (what a new/modified knowledge contributed by the study)
- b) Policy implications (what and how the study informs policy makers).
- c) Recommendation to management practices (Suggestions for addressing challenges faced by the organization and people).
- d) Theoretical implication (where applicable).
- e) Recommendations for further studies (Areas that need further research or investigation).

8.7 References

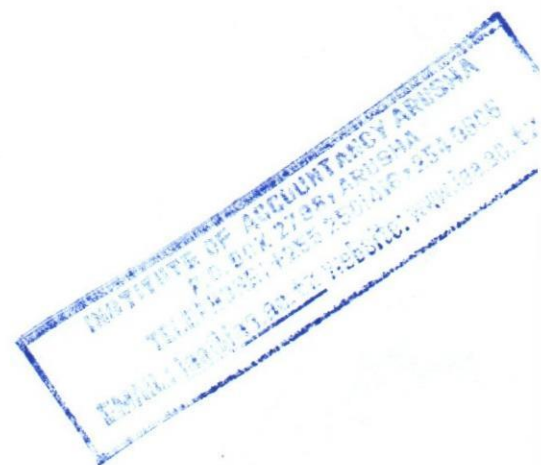
This is a list of all works cited in the dissertation and should be written according to the approved format. The approved format at IAA is IAA: APA Referencing Style (using the most recent version). All sources cited in the text



shall be included in the list of references. References shall be arranged in alphabetical order at the end of the dissertation.

8.8 Appendices

- a) Research Instruments (Questionnaires, Interview Guide, Observation Checklist)
- b) Introduction Letter (from IAA): A letter from IAA confirming that the researcher is a student doing research.
- c) Originality report (Plagiarism report)
- d) Research Permits from organization/firm/company: The students who's their study area is entity/organization/firm/company shall attach a permit from the entity confirming that they were permitted to collect data.
- e) A conference paper/manuscript/published Journal article.
- f) Any other if applicable



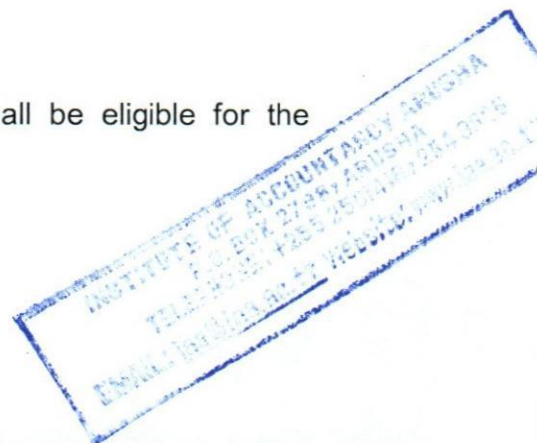
PART V:
ASSIGNING, TRAINING, AND DUTIES OF SUPERVISORS AND
CANDIDATES

9.0 Introduction

The research student's supervisor is a vital source of support, direction, and inspiration. In order to carry out his or her tasks and obligations in an efficient and right manner the supervisor must have a clear understanding of their job. The supervisor's role is to lead, inspire, and encourage rather than simply observe. To be effective, a supervisor needs to possess the necessary experience and "soft" skills. The master degree student must also try to generate excellent research outcomes. This means having a strong commitment to the research, putting in a lot of effort, and paying attention to the supervisors advice.

9.1 Assigning Supervisors

- i. The supervisor is the institute's agent in ensuring that the candidate receives adequate advice, guidance and encouragement on the research project and the proposal/dissertation is reviewed critically for quality on a continuous basis.
- ii. The Head of Department shall carefully consider the supervisor's area of expertise, current workload, his/her qualifications, and supervision experience before appointment.
- iii. The Head of Department shall recommend one supervisor for each candidate and approved by Faculty Dean.
- iv. The cycle for allocation of research supervisors shall be determined by Faculty Dean and indicated in the Institute Almanac and communicated to the students.
- v. The HOD shall communicate to the supervisors and students on the list of supervision.
- vi. Supervision load:
 - a) Every academic member with a PhD shall be eligible for the supervision of master degree students.



- b) If the supervisor is appointed outside IAA shall be those with PhD.
 - c) The maximum supervisor-student ratio is 1:10 per academic year and intake.
 - d) The Head of department shall monitor the number of students for each supervisor.
- vii. The supervisor shall respond and provide feedback and or comments to students within two weeks since the date when a student submitted his/her work for comments.

9.2 Training of Supervisors

The Institute shall endeavor to provide training in supervisory skills including the "soft skills" (effective communication, relationship management, time management, life skills and conflict resolution), research philosophy and management, and IAA Examination Regulations and master degree Guidelines.

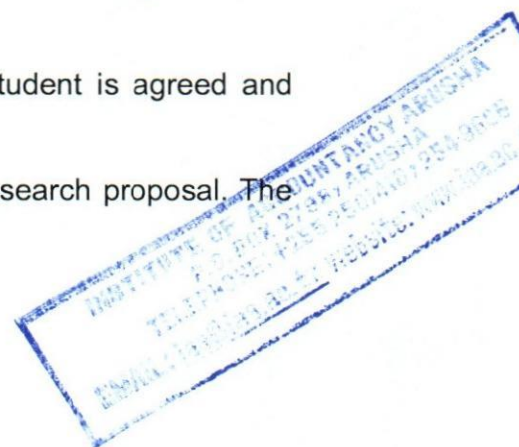
9.3 Supervision Allowances

- a) As an Incentive and token appreciation for the supervisor's work, IAA shall pay supervision allowance to supervisors as per prescribed official documents.
- b) The supervisor shall be paid the prescribed allowance upon the student's successful completion of the dissertation.

9.4 Duties and Responsibilities of Supervisors

The responsibilities of the student with respect to dissertation shall be:

- a) A student maintains satisfactory progress in conducting dissertation;
- b) The student receives adequate advice and encouragement on the dissertation research project;
- c) The work being done on the dissertation is reviewed critically and on a continuous basis.
- d) The dissertation work plan as prepared by the student is agreed and approved.
- e) A student is guided to formulate an appropriate research proposal. The



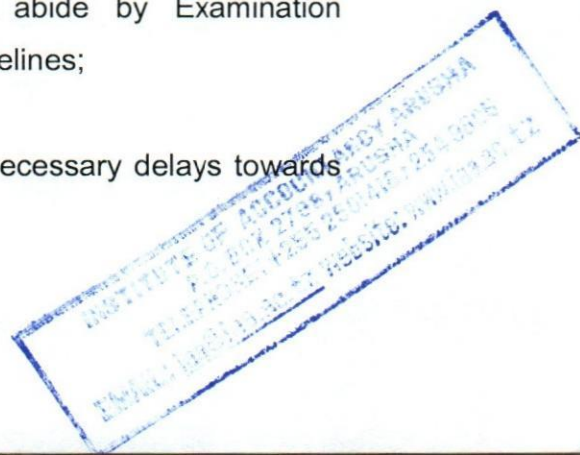
research proposal must be approved by the supervisor hereafter before the student formally begins research activities.

- f) Regular consultations with the student are maintained in order to discuss the research work progress. Frequent consultations help to make the supervisor aware of new problems in the student's research since the last report, and to suggest remedial measures, before it is too late.
- g) A student submits a dissertation of a standard that is acceptable for the intended degree.
- h) To advise and guide the student, not to write the dissertation for the student such that the work becomes a reflection of the supervisor. The student is fully responsible for the work and its fate.
- i) A student is guided in revising the dissertation, in the event that such revisions are recommended by the examiners.
- j) He/she informs the HOD, in writing, if he/she will be away for more than a month and therefore, be unable to supervise student accordingly.

9.5 Duties of supervisee

The responsibilities of the student with respect to dissertation shall be:

- a) To develop an acceptable research proposal for the dissertation work.
- b) To maintain regular contact with the supervisor(s).
- c) Each student shall present a research proposal to the panel before being approved for commencing research data collection.
- d) The composition of the defense panel refers to section 10.1.
- e) To prepare work plan for conducting research and submitting it to the supervisor for approval;
- f) To maintain progress in accordance with the agreed work plan;
- g) To prepare and submit reports on progress of the research to the supervisor and keep the records of the proceedings during all meetings with supervisor.
- h) To make himself/ herself aware of, and abide by Examination Regulations and the requirements of these guidelines;
- i) To avoid plagiarism;
- j) To abide by the work plan so as to avoid unnecessary delays towards



submission of the dissertation;

- k) To exercise the highest level of maturity, honesty and integrity in all curricular activities;
- l) To submit all forms and copies of dissertation to the department as required by these guidelines;
- m) It is strongly emphasized in these guidelines that the student and supervisor shall have to publish at least one journal article from the supervised dissertation.

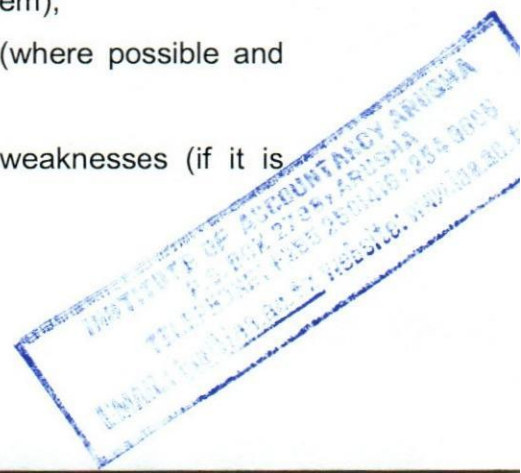
9.6 Conflict Resolution during Supervision

- i. Conflict between a student and supervisor
 - a) In the course of the student's research, a situation may develop where one or more of the following may happen:
 - b) A breakdown in communication between the student and the supervisor;
 - c) Personal clashes and conflicts between the student and the supervisor;
 - d) A hostile relationship between the student and the supervisor;
 - e) Refusal by the student to follow the supervisor's advice
 - f) Competence of supervisor is not reflecting the student's research.

ii. Conflict Resolution

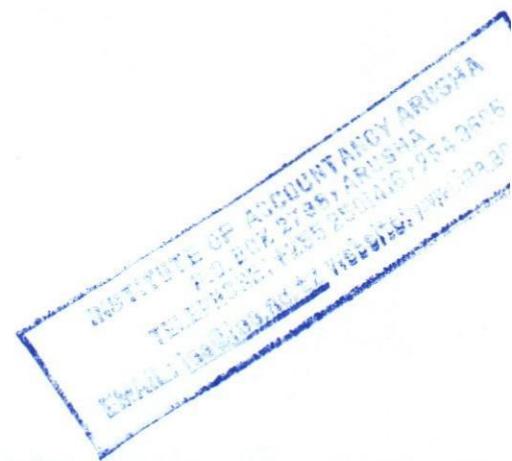
When any of the above situations occurs, the supervisor and/or the student shall report the problem, in writing, to the respective Head of the Department, with a copy to Faculty Dean and Campus Manager. The Head of Department shall study the nature of the problem and recommend to the Faculty Dean and Campus Manager, one of the following actions:

- a) The student be warned, in writing, about his/her weaknesses or conduct (if it is established that s/he is the cause of the problem);
- b) The student be transferred to another supervisor (where possible and necessary);
- c) The supervisor shall be informed about his/her weaknesses (if it is



established that the supervisor is the source of the problem). Depending on the severity of the problem, the supervisor may continue to guide the student, or alternative (b) above may be followed.

- d) An advisory panel be established by the Head of Department to guide the student, if there is no any other person in the department who has the expertise to supervise the student; and
- e) any other reasonable action, including instituting disciplinary proceedings against the student and / or supervisor



PART VI:

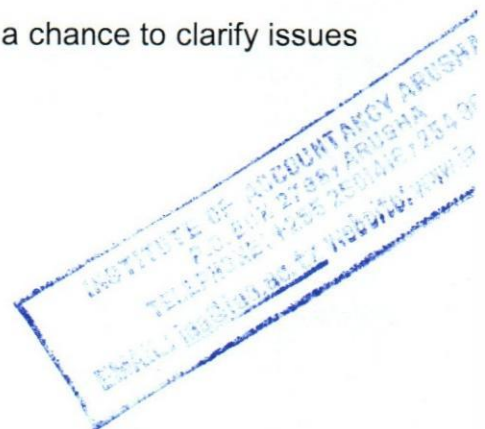
DEFENSE EXAMINATION, PUBLICATION AND DISSERTATION MARKING

10.0 Preconditions

- a) Candidate shall write a proposal and dissertation for which he/she shall have to appear for a defense examination.
- b) The defense examination shall take place only after the supervisor has been contented that the proposal/dissertation submitted by the candidate meets the standard stipulated under this guideline.
- c) During defense examination, the questions to be asked shall basically focus on the candidate's research area. Questions in peripheral areas are also encouraged, if they assist to establish the candidate's level of academic maturity on the dissertation subject matter.
- d) The defense examination shall be administered physically and online for the date and time scheduled. The candidate wishes to defend his proposal or dissertation online shall communicate in writing to the respective HOD and comply with instructions from panelists.
- e) The cycle for defense examinations (proposal or dissertation) shall be determined by Faculty Dean and indicated in the Institute Almanac and communicated to the students.

10.1 Defense Panel

- i. Members of the defense panel shall be selected as such to ensure they are sufficiently qualified and experienced scholars in research or related area to examine the candidate.
- ii. The defense panel shall be composed of a minimum of three faculty members appointed by HOD including:
 - a) Chairperson;
 - b) One or more members who are experts in the subject area of the candidate's dissertation, and
 - c) Secretary;
 - d) Candidate's Supervisor may attend and be given a chance to clarify issues where possible but shall have no vote;



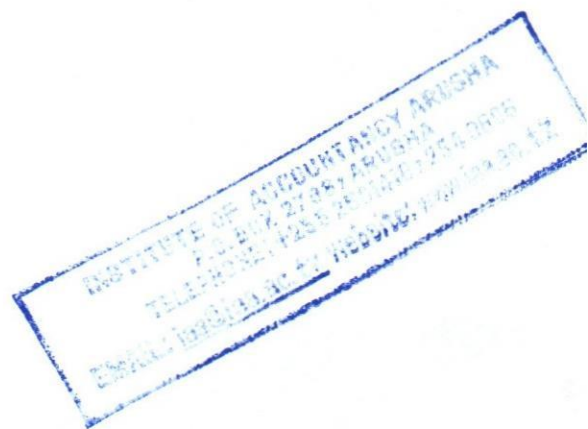
- iii. The HOD shall nominate the chairperson and secretary of each defense panel.

10.2 Information Dissemination on Defense examination

- a) The HOD shall schedule for defense examination based on the defense cycle and Institute Almanac.
- b) The candidate shall submit the research proposal/dissertation approved and signed by supervisor at least two weeks before defense.
- c) The e-signature is only accepted for the supervisor who is residing outside the country but the student shall attach an approval email from supervisor to HOD copied to the student.
- d) The HOD shall issue list of candidates appear for defense examination at least one week before.
- e) The defense panelists shall be provided with copies of the candidate's dissertation document by the responsible head of department at least one week before the date of the defense.

10.3 The rationale for defense examination

- i. The rationale behind defense examination shall be to ascertain that the presented dissertation fulfills the following criteria:
 - a) The proposal/dissertation is the original work of the candidate.
 - b) The candidate has grasped the broader subject area of the study.
 - c) Any weakness in the proposal/dissertation is adequately clarified by the candidate.
- ii. An explicit recommendation is made to the Academic Board as to whether the candidate should be declared to have passed or failed.
- iii. The defense panelists should as possible arrive at unanimous decision on the candidate's performance. Where panelists are unable to reach unanimous agreement as to whether the candidate has passed or failed, average of marks awarded by the Panelists will determine whether the same candidate has passed or failed.

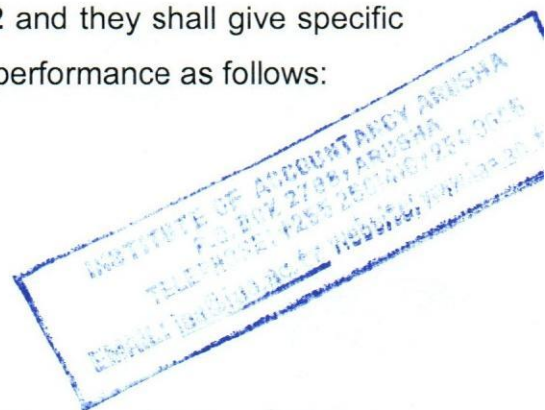


10.4 Proceedings of the defense examination

- i. Duration of the defense examination for Master Degree shall not exceed two hours.
 - a) 30 minutes for presentation;
 - b) 50 minutes for discussion
 - c) 10 minutes for the decision.
- ii. The proceedings of the defense vetted by the panel Chairperson must be submitted to the department within two days after the date of the defense.
 - a) The final decision on the award of the master degree shall be made by the Academic Board on the recommendations of the Departmental Examiners Committee.
 - b) Where a candidate fails the proposal/dissertation defense examination and resubmits the same for re-assessment the maximum grade to be awarded shall be a 'B' grade.
 - c) The dissertation rejected by the examiners after re-submission, shall not be accepted for re-examination at the Institute.
 - d) With exceptional of faculty members and students of the Institute, members of the public are allowed attending defense examination as observers under special permission by the Campus Manager.

10.5 Recommendations after defense examination

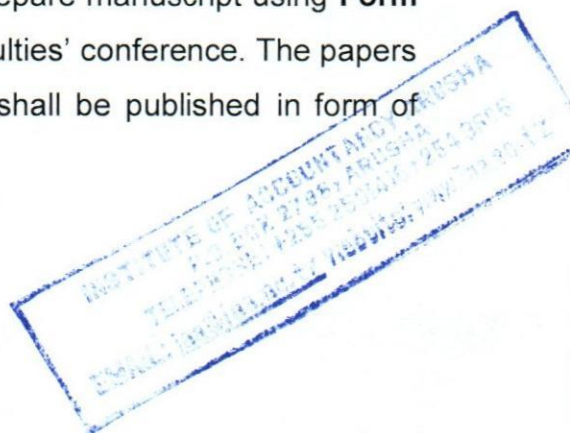
- i. At the end of the defense examination (proposal), members of the panel shall sign the defense results **Form IAA/PGS/F.1** and they shall give specific recommendations to the HOD on the candidate's performance as follows:
 - a) The candidate PASSES with or without minor or major corrections and be allowed for data collection (60%-100%).
 - b) The candidate FAILS BUT should be given another chance to resubmit and defend the proposal after eliminating the weaknesses detailed in the defense proceedings after one month (0-59%).
- ii. At the end of the defense examination (dissertation), members of the panel shall sign the defense results **Form IAA/PGS/F.2** and they shall give specific recommendations to the HOD on the candidate's performance as follows:



- a) The candidate PASSES and no additional corrections in the dissertation are required (100%).
- b) The candidate PASSES subject to making minor corrections and revisions in the dissertation as stated in the defense proceedings, within two weeks (75%-99%).
- c) The candidate PASSES but referred to make substantial corrections and revisions as stated in the defense proceedings, within four weeks, and the Supervisor shall certify that the corrections have been done as directed (50%-74%).
- d) The candidate fails but should be given another chance to resubmit and defend the dissertation after eliminating the weaknesses detailed in the defense proceedings within three months (0-49%).
- iii. The chairperson of the panel shall submit to the HOD a comprehensive report approved by the defense panelists, detailing defense proceedings.
- iv. The defense panel (proposal/dissertation) shall fill the **Form IAA/PGS/F.1** and **Form IAA/PGS/F.2** in quadruplicate and distribution of copies to HOD, DASS, Supervisor and Student.
- v. In tandem with this, each panelist in the defense panel members shall receive an honorarium at the rate approved by the Institute.

10.6 Publication of Research Paper and Faculties' conference

- i. The master degree student shall prepare a manuscript and publish in the Institute Journals or other Journals recognized by the Institute.
- ii. The student who published a research paper in other Journals recognized by the Institute shall submit the same to the HOD-Research and Publication for approval.
- iii. If the student fails to publish a research paper before October (October-intake) or May (March-intake) shall present his/her manuscript in faculties' conference hosted by the Institute.
- iv. The student under guidance of supervisor shall prepare manuscript using **Form IAA/PGS/F.3** to be submitted/presented in the faculties' conference. The papers submitted/presented to the faculties' conference shall be published in form of

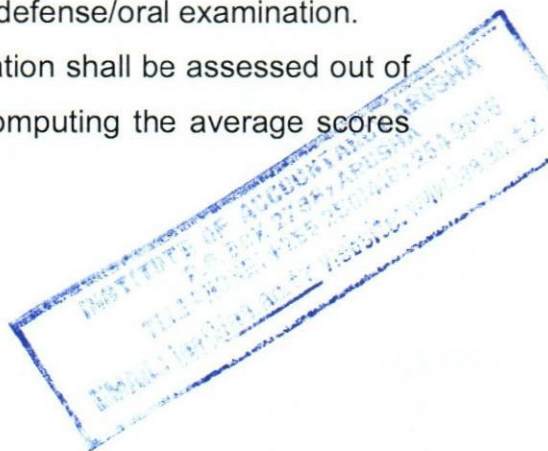


conference proceedings. Few articles that meet requirements shall be published in the Institute Journals.

- v. The reviewers of the conference manuscripts shall be appointed by HOD and shall evaluate the manuscript using the **Form IAA/PGS/F.4**.
- vi. The publication or manuscript shall be related to the area or subject of the dissertation under examination and prepared within the study period.
- vii. The candidate's conference paper/Journal article submitted for the Faculties' conference or published in other Journals recognized by the Institute and approved by HOD-Research and Publication, shall be attached as appendix to the dissertation submitted for marking and Black Book.
- viii. All candidates shall participate in the conference proceedings upon payment of participation fee which covers paper review, venue, tea/coffee and lunch.
- ix. The conference participation fee is TZS 200,000.00 and may be reviewed from time to time by the Institute.

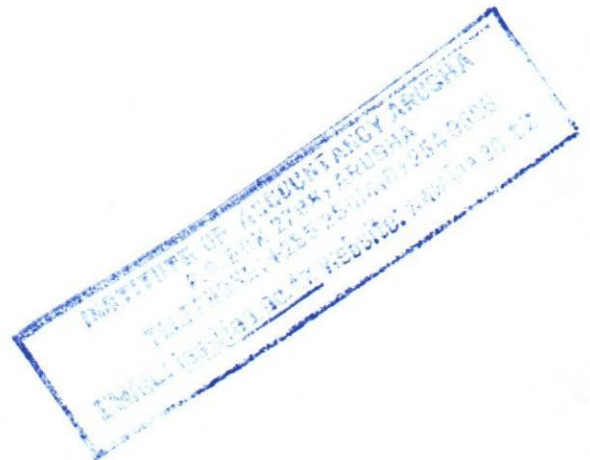
10.7 Dissertation Marking

- i. The dissertation with PASS status on the defense examination shall be submitted for grading.
- ii. Before final submission, the candidate will submit two loose – bound (spiral bound) copies for the final marking.
- iii. The submitted dissertation shall be marked by two internal examiners of which one is the candidate supervisor.
- iv. The markers shall use the **Form IAA/PGS/F.5** to grade the dissertation.
- v. The cycle for dissertations marking shall be determined by Faculty Dean and indicated in the Institute Almanac.
- vi. Each Marker shall prepare a summary score sheet using **Form IAA/PGS/F.6** for reports he/she marked (whether 1st or 2nd marking). The summary shall be submitted to HODs, and be used for verification of DEC results.
- vii. The highest marks for the dissertation (document examination) shall be 65% whereas remaining scores (35%) shall be for the defense/oral examination.
- viii. The defense examination and document examination shall be assessed out of 100 and the final scores shall be obtained by computing the average scores for defense, first marker and second marker.



10.8 Dissertations Review by External Examiner

- i. The marked dissertations shall be reviewed by external examiners for the purpose of providing impartial view and independent advice.
- ii. The appointment and proceedings of external examiners shall be in accordance to the Assessment of Student's Performance Regulations made under section 22 of the IAA Act (Cap. 240 R.E. 2002).



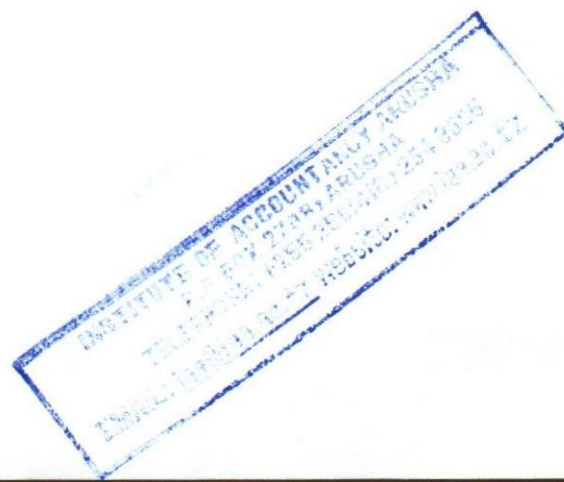
PART VII:
PROOFREADING, EDITING AND PRINTING OF FINAL DISSERTATION (BLACK BOOK)

11.0 Proofreading and editing

- i. The candidate should ensure that his/her dissertation is checked and demonstrates high standards of accuracy. This shall be done through proofreading and editing. Issues to be checked shall include: layout, spelling, grammar, and sentences structures. Others shall be list of references, cross-references and sequences of numbers. In addition, figures, diagrams and tables shall have been numbered sequentially in the manuscript.
- ii. The candidate should note that, as a general rule, it is not the duty of Supervisor to proofread or edit the supervised work. If the dissertation requires editing, the Supervisor may advise the candidate of the need, and if appropriate, s/he may give advice on where to obtain assistance with typographical proofreading and editing.
- iii. The candidate is warned that the Institute is not responsible for the costs accrued from editorial works.
- iv. The candidate is responsible for ensuring that no changes are introduced to the intellectual content in the process of typographical editing.

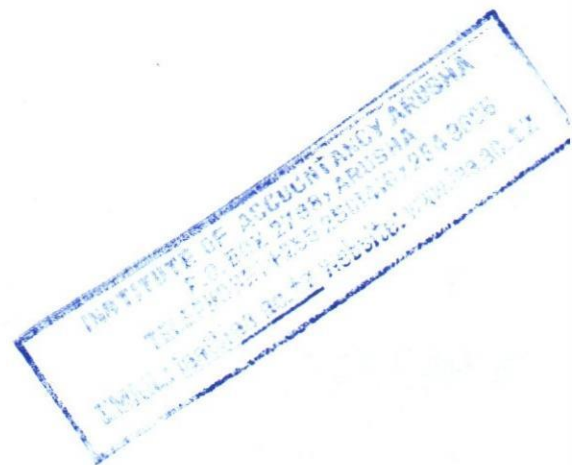
11.1 Printing of Final Dissertation (Black Book)

- i. The candidate shall observe all format and style requirements in accordance with section 6 of this guideline.
- ii. For purpose of enhancing similarity and compliance with formatting and style requirements, all candidates shall print the final dissertation (Black Book) in the Printing Unit (Bureau of Consultancy) of the Institute or any other external Printer approved by the Institute.
- iii. The candidate shall be responsible for printing cost of the Black Book.



11.2 Final Submission Dissertation (Black Book)

- a) After satisfactorily completing all recommended corrections, the candidate shall submit three hard bound copies of the dissertation to the respective HOD. One copy will be returned to the student, one will be given to the supervisor (option) and the third one will be deposited in the Institute library. If the supervisor is not preferred to receive the hardcopy, the student will submit two hard bound copies only.
- b) The final dissertations (black book) shall be submitted to the respective HOD in the respective Campus at least 14 days before graduation using error free copy certification (**Form IAA/PGS/F.7**).
- c) The student shall fill the error free copy and certified by Department of Library Services indicating that dissertation meets the formats and style requirements. The copy of the form is distributed to Examination office, Library, respective HOD and student.
- d) Each copy shall be bound Black. Only the title of the dissertation, full name of the candidate, the degree for which the dissertation has been submitted, and the year of degree award, embossed in gold will appear on the cover page.
- e) The spine of the dissertation shall be embossed in gold, bearing:
 - i. The surname and initials of the candidate
 - ii. the degree for which the dissertation has been submitted
 - iii. the year of degree award, and
 - iv. should be in 14 font size



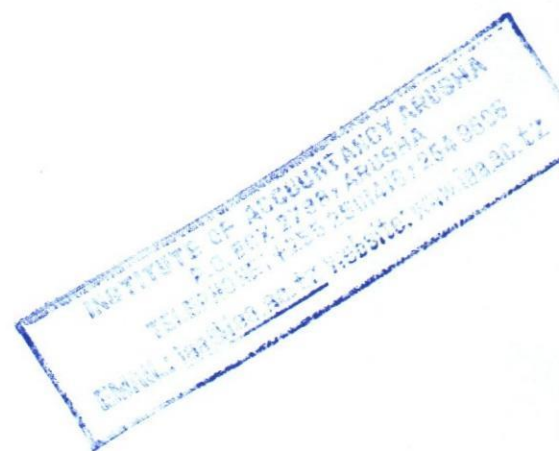
12.0 Effective Guideline Date and Guideline Review

12.1 Effective Guideline Date

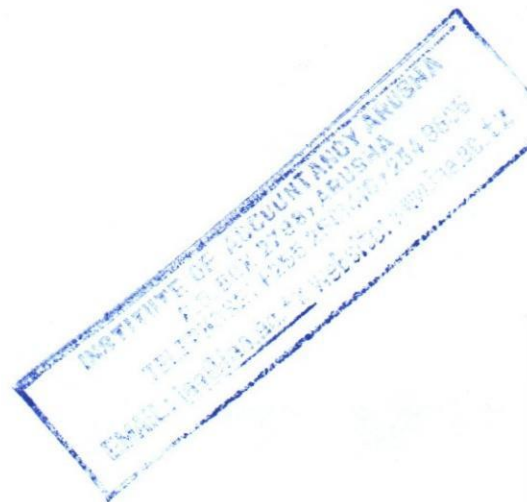
This guideline shall become operational upon approval by the Governing Council of the Institute of Accountancy Arusha.

12.2 Guideline Review

In the event that any statement in the guideline provisions is outdated, or a need to introduce new statements arises, such statements may be changed or modified at the directives and approval of the Governing Council.



LIST OF APPENDICES



Appendix 1: Form IAA/PGS/F.1: Defense Examiner's Report (Proposal)

**INSTITUTE OF ACCOUNTANCY ARUSHA
MASTERS DEGREE PROGRAMME**

SN	EXAMINER'S RECOMMENDATION	Tick (✓)
1.	The candidate PASSES with or without minor or major corrections and be allowed for data collection (specify minor corrections on separate sheet)	PASS (60%-100%)
2.	The candidate FAILS BUT should be given another chance to resubmit and defend the proposal after eliminating the weaknesses detailed in the defense proceedings after one month (specify weaknesses on separate sheet)	FAIL (0-59%)

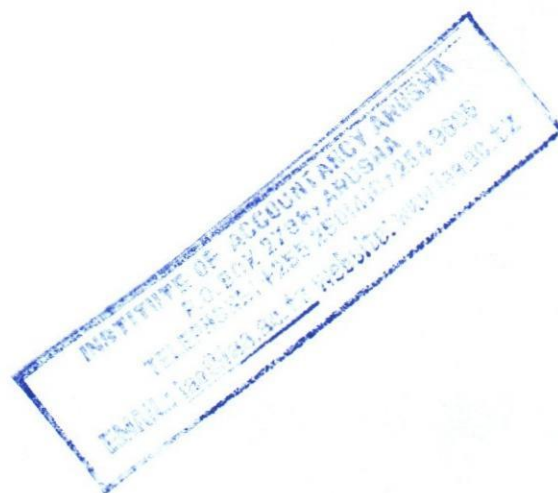
OVERAL MARKS: _____ **STATUS (Write PASS or FAIL):** _____

Panel Members:

SN	Name	Position*	Signature	Date

*Chairperson or member

Note: Filled in quadruplicate and distribute copies to: HOD, DASS, Supervisor and Student



Appendix 2: Form IAA/PGS/F.2: Defense Examiner's Report (Dissertation)

INSTITUTE OF ACCOUNTANCY ARUSHA MASTERS DEGREE PROGRAMME

SN	EXAMINER'S RECOMMENDATION	Tick (✓)
1.	PASSES AS IT IS (no revisions or typographical corrections required)	100%
2.	PASSES SUBJECT TO minor changes (list the errors/changes on separate sheet) *	75%-99%
3.	PASSES SUBJECT TO substantial corrections and revisions as indicated in the examination report**	50%-74%
4.	NOT ACCEPTED BUT MAY BE RE-SUBMITTED after one or more of the following. Please tick (✓): Additional data collection Additional analysis Additional literature review and revisions Re-writing Others (specify on separate sheet)	FAIL (0-49%)

* Minor changes refer to editorial corrections, slight re-organisation of sections and minor modifications of tables, paragraphs or sentences *to be submitted within two weeks*.

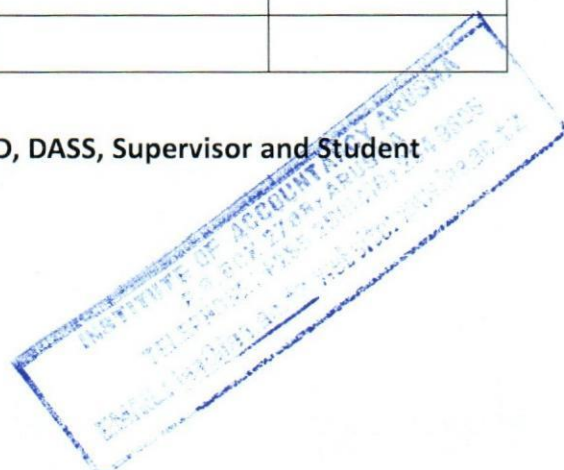
** Substantial corrections and revisions as stated in the examiners' reports *to be submitted within four weeks*.

Panel Members:

SN	Name	Position*	Signature	Date

*Chairperson or member

Note: Filled in quadruplicate and distribute copies to: HOD, DASS, Supervisor and Student

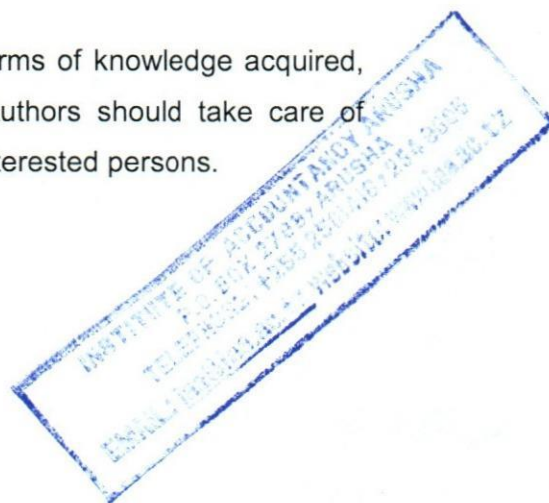


Appendix 3: Form IAA/PGS/F.3: IAA Conference Paper/Manuscript Structure

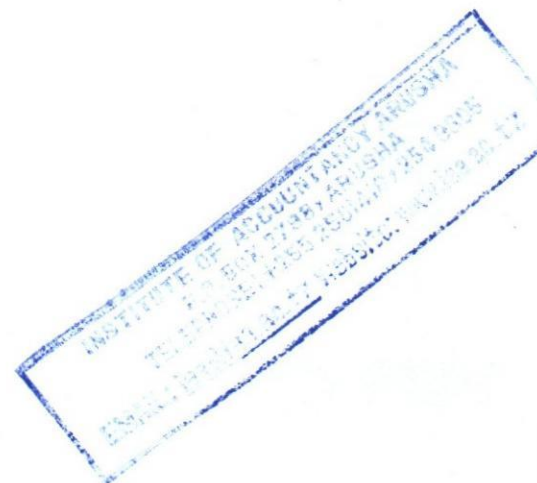
INSTITUTE OF ACCOUNTANCY ARUSHA IAA CONFERENCE PAPER/JOURNAL ARTICLE STRUCTURE

The articles should conform to the following structure: -

- (a) **An author's abstract** of between 100 and 150 words should appear at the beginning of the article. This should be complete in itself, outlining the purpose, method and findings or contribution to knowledge.
- (b) **Introduction/Overview:** To introduce the subject matter contained in the article by highlighting the objectives of the articles and the expected outcomes of the discussion. This section should show how the article is organized, tools of analysis used to illustrate points (e.g. figure and exhibits) and sources of information being discussed.
- (c) **Literature Review:** To show particulars of literature reviewed and secondary data collected. Source of information must be specifically shown by acknowledging the works of former researchers and by examining arguments of forerunners and predecessors on the issues.
- (d) **Methodology:** To describe how the research was undertaken, hypotheses/research questions used, research design, how data was collected (questionnaires, interviews) and analyzed, models used, sampling techniques, and other methods of data collection.
- (e) **Findings:** To state the findings of the study as revealed by the data analyzed. Where the study does not cover an empirical study, authors should state their confirmed opinions as might be supported by well-presented arguments.
- (f) **Discussion of findings:** To discuss the findings in terms of knowledge acquired, studies/literature made, and experiences gathered. Authors should take care of implication of their discussion and findings to specific interested persons.



- (g) **Other Considerations:** Where appropriate, extensive details, tables, diagrams and illustrations should be presented within the text. Figures and exhibits must be supported by clear headings.
- (h) **Conclusion(s):** To emphasis on the main issues raised in the discussion and give well-constructed recommendations where appropriate.
- (i) Enough bibliographic information should be provided to identify documents consulted uniquely. References should be listed at the end of the articles in alphabetical order (see example on Appendix 1). Notes should be sparingly used.
- (j) When tables are necessary, they should be numbered consecutively in the Arabic numerals.



**Appendix 4: Form IAA/PGS/F.4: IAA Conference Paper/Manuscript Structure
Review Form**

**INSTITUTE OF ACCOUNTANCY ARUSHA
MASTERS DEGREE PROGRAMME**

MANUSCRIPT REVIEW FORM

Dear _____

Thank you for your willingness to review this conference paper/manuscript. You are kindly requested to give constructive criticism and comments regarding its content, grammar and general setup for quality assurance and informed decisions whether or not to have it included in the faculties' conference. You are kindly expected to return the review report within **five (5) days** from the date you received this request.

Reviewer's Information (To be completed by the reviewer)

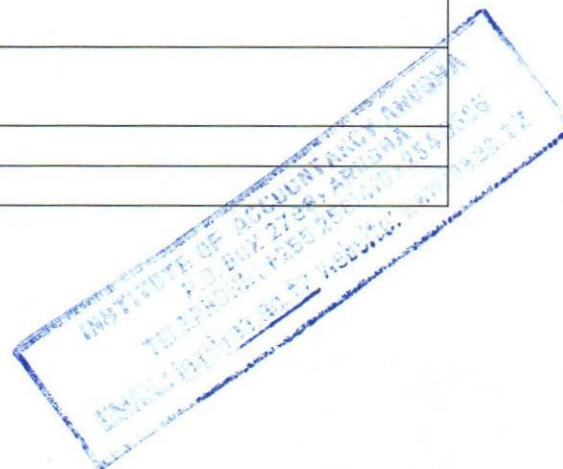
Title of Reviewer	
Name of Reviewer	
Email address	
Institution	
Country	
Area of Specialization	

Manuscript Information

Manuscript Number	
Date Sent to Reviewer	
Expected Date of Return	

EVALUATION (Give details in each of the following sub-headings)

Topic	
Abstract	
Introduction/ Background	
Review of Related Literature and Studies	
Research Methodology	
Results/ Findings	



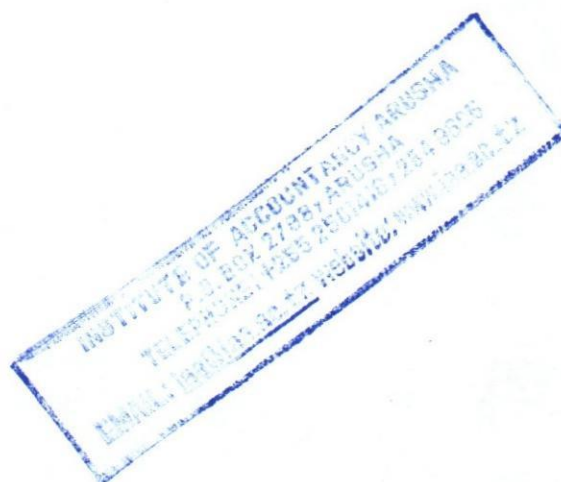
Discussion	
Conclusions	
Recommendations	
References	
Additional Comment	

Rating of the manuscript: Use (5 = Excellent) (4 = Very Good) (3 = Average) (2 = Fair) (1 = poor)

Originality	
Contribution to The Field	
Technical Quality	
Clarity of Presentation	
Depth of Research	

Recommendation: Please, mark with an X

Accept as It Is	
Accepted with Minor Corrections	
Accepted with Moderate Revision	
Accepted with Major Revision	
Reject (Give Reasons)	

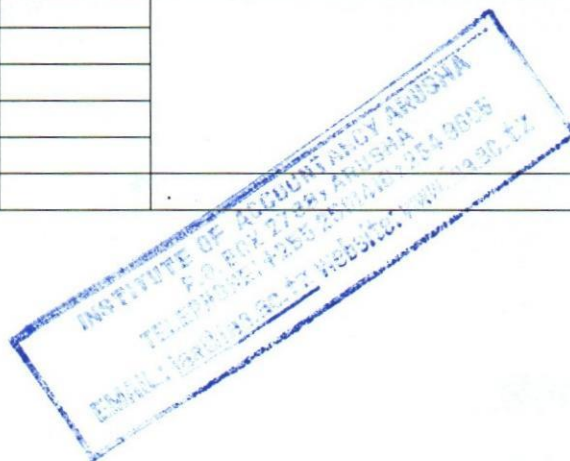


Appendix 5: Form IAA/PGS/F.5: Marking Sheet for Dissertation Reports

INSTITUTE OF ACCOUNTANCY ARUSHA MASTERS DEGREE PROGRAMME MARKING SHEET FOR DISSERTATION REPORTS

Student Surname (Family Name)		Forename(s) (Given Name)	
Student ID no.		Research Topic:	
<i>Supervisors Please fill all these fields in accurately</i>		Module Code	
Name of First Examiner		Name of Second Examiner	
Signature of First Examiner		Signature of Second Examiner	
Date of Marking		Date of Marking	

S/No.	Category	Max Score	Examiner Awards			Specific comments and/or justification of marks awarded (strengths and/or weaknesses of key issues described)
			Key Issue	Score (%)	Award (%)	
1	Abstract	4	1.1	1		
			1.2	1		
			1.3.1	0.5		
			1.3.2	0.5		
			1.3.3	0.5		
			1.3.4	0.5		
		Subtotal (x/4)		4		
2	Introduction	10	Examiner Awards			Specific comments and/or justification of marks awarded (strengths and/or weaknesses of key issues described)
			Key Issue	Score (%)	Award (%)	
			2.1	2		
			2.2	2		
			2.3	2		
			2.4	2		
			2.5	2		
		Subtotal (x/10)		10		



3	Literature Review	Max Score	Examiner Awards			Specific comments and/or justification of marks awarded (strengths and/or weaknesses of key issues described)
			Key Issue	Score (%)	Award (%)	
		20	3.1	4		
			3.2	4		
			3.3	4		
			3.4	4		
			3.5	4		
		Subtotal (x/20)		20		
4	Research Methodology	Max Score	Examiner Awards			Specific comments and/or justification of marks awarded (strengths and/or weaknesses of key issues described)
			Key Issue	Score (%)	Award (%)	
		20	4.1	2		
			4.2	2		
			4.3	4		
			4.4	2		
			4.5	4		
			4.6	3		
			4.7	3		
		Subtotal (x/20)		20		
5	Presentation and Discussion of findings	Max Score	Examiner Awards			Specific comments and/or justification of marks awarded (strengths and/or weaknesses of key issues described)
			Key issue	Score (%)	Award (%)	
		32	5.1	4		
			5.2	7		
			5.3	7		
			5.4	4		
			5.5	4		
		Subtotal (x/32)		26		
6	Conclusion, Recommendations and Policy Implications and Critical Evaluation of the Study	Max Score	Examiner Awards			Specific comments and/or justification of marks awarded (strengths and/or weakness of key issues described)
			Key issue	Score (%)	Award (%)	
		10	6.1	2		
			6.2	2		
			6.3	1		
			6.4	2		
			6.5	1		
			6.6	2		
		Subtotal (x/10)		10		
7	Appendices (instruments,	Max Score	Examiner Awards			Specific comments and/or justification of marks awarded (strengths and/or weakness of
			Key issue	Score (%)	Award (%)	

originality report, conference paper/manuscript, research permit) and Referencing					key issues described)
	4	7.1	1		
		7.2	1		
		7.3	5		
		7.4	1		
		7.5	2		
	Subtotal (x/4)		10		
Total (x/100)			100		

Please indicate if you are:

First Examiner			Overall		
Second Examiner					

Final mark agreed by both markers

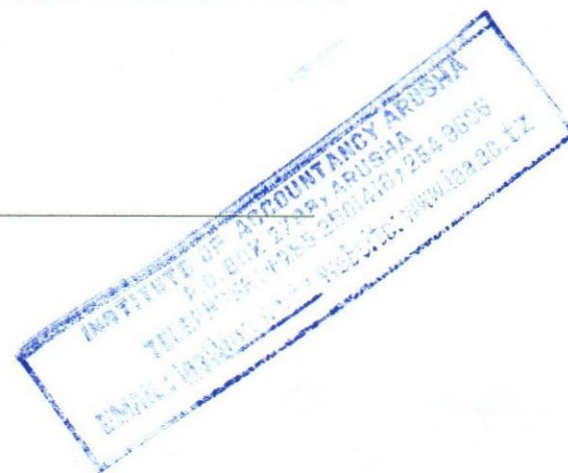
Date: Signatures: (First Examiner)

Date: : Signatures: (Second Examiner)

Grading System

Dissertation shall be awarded out of 100 percent – Any score below 50% shall be considered fail. The following shall be used for the purpose of grading:

Score Range	Grade	Definition
70 – 100	A	Excellent
60 – 69	B+	Very Good
50 – 59	B	Pass
40 – 49	C	Fail
35 – 39	D	Fail
0 – 34	F	Absolute Fail



KEY ISSUES DESCRIBED

1. Abstract [4%]

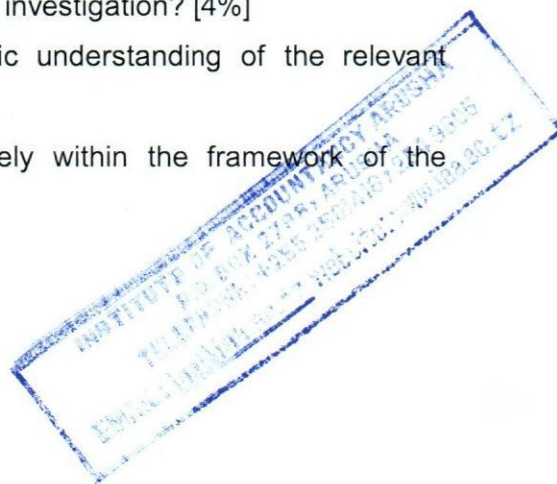
- 1.1. Doesn't abstract exceed 500 words in length? [1%]
- 1.2. Is abstract concise and in a single paragraph, written in a rational and scientific manner for easy understanding? [1%]
- 1.3. Does abstract constitute the following (in brief)
 - 1.3.1. Practical, scientific, theoretical or artistic gap the research/project is filling (Motivation/problem statement) [0.5%]
 - 1.3.2. Very brief but clear methods/procedure/approach [0.5%]
 - 1.3.3. Very brief but clear main results/findings/product [0.5%]
 - 1.3.4. Very brief but clear larger implications of the findings, especially for the problem/gap identified above (Conclusion/implications/recommendations) [0.5%]

2. Introduction [10%]

- 2.1. Is the relevant background presented, discussed and explained well? [2%]
- 2.2. Is the research problem clearly specified and contextualized? [2%]
- 2.3. How clear are the objectives of the proposed research? [2%]
- 2.4. Are the research questions and/or hypotheses clearly formulated? [2%]
- 2.5. Does the dissertation capture clear relevance/rationale/ justification of the chosen topic? [2%]

3. Literature Review [20%]

- 3.1. Does the dissertation include a comprehensive review of (both theoretical and empirical) relevant literature? A candidate should demonstrate deeply impressive command of literature, drawing on an exemplary range of material/evidence and/or examining the topic in considerable detail [4%].
- 3.2. Is there critique of existing literature and is it clearly linked back to the relevance of the chosen topic? [4%]
- 3.3. Is there demonstration of sensitivity to the limits/limitations of evidence? Or is there a description on how the proposed research positions itself within the generic context of the previous studies in the area under investigation? [4%]
- 3.4. Does the candidate demonstrate a systematic understanding of the relevant background theory and knowledge? [4%]
- 3.5. Is the theory been contextualized appropriately within the framework of the research problem in question? [4%]



4. Research Plan/Methodology [20%]

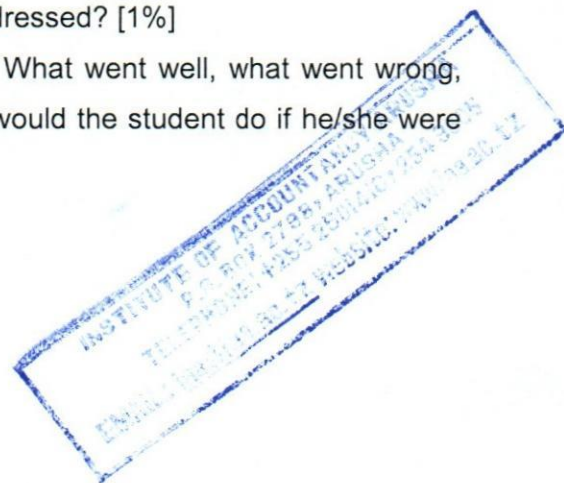
- 4.1. Is the adopted methodology and/or design approach clearly described and justified? [2%]
- 4.2. Does the dissertation demonstrate exemplary sensitivity in the use of quantitative and/or qualitative methods? [2%]
- 4.3. Are data analysis techniques relevant to specific objectives of research? [4%]
- 4.4. Is the sampling method and makeup of the sample clearly described? [2%]
- 4.5. Are research tools or data collection methods standard and clearly explained? [4%]
- 4.6. Have the issues of validity, reliability and generalizability been addressed? [3%]
- 4.7. Is there a clear identification of any limitations, assumptions and constraints which may influence the applied methodology, research design and implementation? [3%]

5. Presentation and Discussion of Findings [32%]

- 5.1. Are data reliable and valid? (i.e. enough and right data in relation to objectives of stud) [4%]
- 5.2. Are the results clearly presented and analyzed objectively? [7%].
- 5.3. Are the results discussed objectively and adequately? [7%].
- 5.4. Do the results lead to appropriate conclusions and/or fulfillment of the study objectives? [4%].
- 5.5. Does the analysis, evaluation and discussion of results exhibit independence of thought? Are there new ideas? [4%].

6. Conclusion, Recommendations and Policy Implications and Critical Evaluation of the Study [10%]

- 6.1. Are the conclusions consistent with the results/findings? [2%]
- 6.2. How closely do the conclusions address the objectives? [2%]
- 6.3. Has knowledge been extended? [1%]
- 6.4. How appropriate/feasible are the recommendations? [2%]
- 6.5. Has the need for any further research been addressed? [1%]
- 6.6. What happened when doing the dissertation? What went well, what went wrong, was research techniques manageable? What would the student do if he/she were to repeat the same research again? [2%].



7 Appendices and Referencing [4%]

7.1 Are the research instruments attached? [1%].

7.2 Is the originality report attached? [1%].

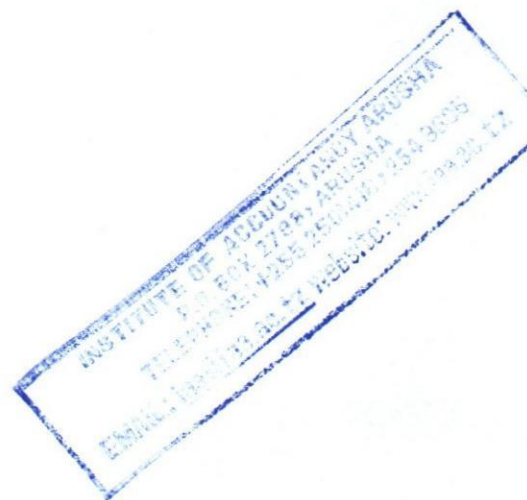
7.3 Is the conference paper/manuscripts/journal article attached? [5%].

7.4 Is the research permit attached? [1%]

7.5 Is the referencing good [2%].

8. The highest marks for the dissertation (document examination): 65%

9. The highest marks for the Presentation/Defense (Marks as per Panel) [35%]



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Appendix 7: Form IAA/PGS/F.7: Error Free Copy Certification

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Error Free Copy Certification

(This form should be filled by student in quadruplicate when signing the dissertation for final submission)

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